Late-Time Mass Inflation in Double-Null Evolutions: Event-Horizon-Regular Data, the Interior Linear Response and Exact Integration Along a Ray

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Abstract

Mass inflation at an inner horizon is a late-time phenomenon: the mass grows like $e^{\kappa_- v}$ and a double-null evolution reaches only $v \sim 10^2$ to 3×10^2, with a truncation error that itself grows with v. We develop and test a method for this regime in a system whose static interior and ray equations are exact (no published evolution is reproduced), the spherical Einstein–nonlinear-electrodynamics–massless-scalar system with an additive closure $M = \mu + M_N(r)$ whose static interior is a Hayward-type regular black hole ($r_- = 1.057475$, $r_+ = 9.897927$, $\kappa_- = 0.795649$, $\kappa_+ = 0.048969$). (1) With data regular on the event horizon, the metric exponent at the Cauchy horizon follows the surface gravity of the accumulated mass, $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$, not the static one (0.02–0.08% on one ray, 0.10–0.32% on another, for $k = 3/2$; 0.3–2.5% for $k = 1/2$, not relaxed). (2) The ingoing flux at the Cauchy horizon is the linear response of the static interior to the horizon flux: its kernel follows from the interior wave equation (known ingredients; the zero-frequency gain $(1 + r_+^2/r_-^2)/2$ is Ori's coefficient), has decay rate κ_+, and reproduces the measured flux to 4×10^{-4} at $B = 0.003$ (no parameter is fitted to the flux, but numerical choices in the kernel change the prediction by up to 1.2×10^{-3}); at $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$ the agreement is 3×10^{-4} and constant to 2×10^{-5} for $150 \le v \le 420$. At $B = 0.03$ the flux is 3.5% above the linear response of the static hole and 0.6–0.7% ($k \ge 3/2$) to 1.9% ($k = 1/2$) above that of the hole of the accumulated mass; the remainder is of second order in the amplitude, its coefficient depends on the profile and the injection time (0.25 to $6\,\mu_f$ for compact pulses), and it is bounded by $\lesssim 6\,\mu_f$ over all profiles tested; there is no universal matching factor. (3) The field equations integrate exactly along a ray, $d\ln M/dv = 4\pi r\phi_v^2/\rho$ for $M \gg r$, with ρ the exponentially filtered flux. This reproduces the Romberg-extrapolated PDE mass to 6×10^{-5} ($k = 3/2$) and 2×10^{-6} ($k = 1/2$) over seventeen to nineteen decades of growth up to $v = 108$ and is grid-converged to 10^{-5} in $\ln M$, whereas the grid-extrapolated PDE mass is not (the second-order error of r_v grows with v and its level spread understates its error by a median factor of 1.4–1.5×10^2 at $B = 0.03$ and 4–8 at $B = 0.003$ over $84 \le v \le 290$; at $B = 0.03$ the factor is at least 8 at the tabulated v and below 1 at one integer v in 207, next to a sign change of the difference). A PDE reference that replaces the evolved r_U and r_v by the two Raychaudhuri constraints, with y from a positive integral and so without calibration, agrees with the ray integration in $\ln M$ to 1.4×10^{-6} ($B = 0.03$, all four tails) and 2.3×10^{-6} ($B = 0.003$) up to $v = 280$, where $M \sim e^{160}$–e^{180}. (4) In a model driven by the kernel flux beyond $v = 250$, the ray integration reaches the Ori tail law in M at $v \gtrsim 10^3$: $(\kappa_- - d\ln M/dv)(v+1) = 5.02$ for $k = 3/2$ against $2k+2 = 5$ at $v = 2500$, and 3.01 against 3 for $k = 1/2$ at $B = 0.003$. In the window reached by the PDE ($v \lesssim 110$) the rate is not the tail law; for steep tails it is close to $\kappa_-(\mu_f) - 2\kappa_+$ at $v \approx 60$. We state what the method does not show: the closure is additive, the amplitude of M is that of the discrete solution, the flux beyond $v \approx 250$ at $B = 0.03$ is a linear-response model, and nothing here addresses extendibility.

1 Introduction

The growth of the Misner–Sharp mass at the Cauchy horizon of a charged black hole (mass inflation; Poisson and Israel 1990, Ori 1991) is described by the null-shell model of Ori [1991]; in the form used here its late-time rate is $\kappa_- - (2k+2)/v$ for an ingoing tail $\phi \propto v^{-k}$, the exponent $2k+2$ being that of the flux ϕ_v^2, and the coefficient with which an event-horizon tail reaches the Cauchy horizon is that of Ori [1998]. A double-null evolution of the full system can in principle test this, but the quantity of interest grows by e^{170} before the grid ends, the truncation error of r_v grows with it, and the prescription of the initial data on interior rays fixes the time variable to the static advanced time, in which the metric exponent is $-\kappa_-^{\mathrm{static}}$ by construction. This paper is the methodology that Paper E [Ownby, 2026b] used to read the Ori law and the metric exponent from such an evolution. It is a self-contained treatment because it does not depend on the Hayward series: it is formulated for spherical Einstein–scalar systems with an inner horizon but is tested only in the additive-closure system of Paper E, where it was developed.

What is done.

1. Data regular on the event horizon (teleological horizon data, Eddington–Finkelstein gauge), with a five-grid streaming Richardson–Romberg extrapolation of the signed series (Section 3).

2. An analysis of where the ingoing flux at the Cauchy horizon comes from: the linear response of the static interior to the horizon flux, with a kernel computed from the interior wave equation (Section 4), tests against the evolution, its limits, and its use in a shell model.

3. The exact ray equations, their use as a reference for the extrapolated mass, and a constraint-projected PDE mass that does not rest on the evolved first derivatives (Section 5).

4. An extension of the mass to $v = 3000$ driven by the kernel flux beyond the grid, with the Ori tail law as its output (Section 5).

What comes from the literature. The zero-frequency gain of the kernel is Ori's coefficient [Ori, 1998]; the tail $\phi \propto v^{-k}$ on the event horizon with $k = 3$ (data without an initial static field) or $k = 2$ (initially static field), for $\ell = 0$, is Price's law [Price, 1972] as derived on $\mathcal{H}^+$ in the linearized analysis of Gundlach et al. [1994b] and, for $k = 3$, proved by Dafermos and Rodnianski [2005] and Angelopoulos et al. [2018]; the diamond scheme is that of scalar collapse [Gundlach et al., 1994a]; the results on the Cauchy horizon of charged and cosmological black holes that frame the problem are Dafermos [2005] (nonlinear, spherical symmetry) and Luk and Oh [2017], Hintz and Vasy [2017], Costa and Franzen [2017], Kehle and Shlapentokh-Rothman [2019] (linear waves on Reissner–Nordström, Reissner–Nordström–de Sitter and Kerr–de Sitter), which we use at the level of context. What we do not find in the sources we read is the combination of the three steps above as a validated pipeline with stated error constants; that is the contribution, and it is a methodological one.

What this paper does not do. It does not treat the mass-tracking closure of the series (Paper F [Ownby, 2026c] studies that closure's ray equations in quasi-topological gravity), the Hawking flux (Paper E, anomaly-term model) or extendibility. Each result below is of one of four kinds: *derived* and checked independently; *reproduced* from the literature; *measured* with a stated convergence statement; or *model-driven*.

2 System, closure and scheme (as in Paper E)

With $ds^2 = -W\,du\,dv + r^2 d\Omega^2$, $W = e^{\sigma}$, and the NED monopole stress tensor ($T_{uu} = T_{vv} = 0$, $\rho = \rho(r)$, $p_r = -\rho$, $p_t = -\rho - r\rho'/2$) written through $M_N(r) = m_N r^3/(r^3 + a_N)$, $\rho = M_N'/(4\pi r^2)$, and a minimally coupled massless scalar with $\mathcal{L} = -\frac{1}{2}(\partial\phi)^2$, i.e. $T_{ab} = \partial_a\phi\partial_b\phi - \frac{1}{2}g_{ab}(\partial\phi)^2$, the field equations are

$$r_{uv} = -\frac{r_u r_v}{r} - \frac{W}{4r}\big(1 - 2M_N'(r)\big), \tag{1}$$

$$\sigma_{uv} = -\frac{2r_{uv}}{r} - 8\pi\phi_u\phi_v + \frac{W\,M_N''(r)}{2r}, \tag{2}$$

$$\phi_{uv} = -\frac{r_u\phi_v + r_v\phi_u}{r}, \tag{3}$$

with the Misner–Sharp mass and the constraints

$$M = \tfrac{r}{2}\big(1 + 4r_u r_v/W\big), \qquad r_{uu} - \sigma_u r_u + 4\pi r\phi_u^2 = 0 \quad (\text{and } u \leftrightarrow v). \tag{4}$$

We derived (1)–(3) by hand and check them in `code/eh_init/check_field_equations.py`: fields with prescribed second derivatives (finite-difference Riemann tensor of the four-dimensional metric, scalar plus NED-monopole stress tensor) obey $G_{ab} - 8\pi T_{ab} = 0$ in all four components to 3×10^{-6} when (1), (2) and the constraints are imposed, and each component departs by 0.07–1.6 when its own second derivative is changed by 0.1; $\Box\phi = 0$ is (3) to 10^{-15}. The static Hayward interior is reproduced by the $A = B = 0$ validation below. The closure is *additive*, $M = \mu + M_N(r)$, where μ is the part of the mass carried by the scalar: $G = (\partial_r M)_m = M_N'(r)$ is independent of M, as in the Reissner–Nordström case; Paper E [Ownby, 2026b] shows (under stated assumptions) why this is the only closure a separately conserved dark sector allows. It is not the mass-tracking closure of this series ($a \propto m$): a_N and m_N are fixed by the NED charge, and the static sector of the mass-tracking closure is realized in four-dimensional quasi-topological gravity, whose dynamics differ from this system (Paper F [Ownby, 2026c]). The runs below therefore test a method, in a Lagrangian system with known ingredients; they do not test the $s = 0$ metric of the series. We use $m_N = 5$, $a_N = 10$ (so $\ell^2 = a_N/2m_N = 1$), for which the static interior has $r_- = 1.057475$, $r_+ = 9.897927$, $\kappa_- = 0.795649$, $\kappa_+ = 0.048969$.

Scheme. The evolved variables are $r, \sigma, r_u, r_v, \sigma_u, \sigma_v, \phi_u, \phi_v$ (first-order form), so that quantities that are exponentially small near the Cauchy horizon, such as r_u, r_v and W, keep full relative precision. The scheme is a double-null diamond scheme of the type used for scalar-field collapse [Gundlach et al., 1994a], extended by evolving the first derivatives as independent variables: r, σ are advanced by the diamond identity and the first derivatives by trapezoidal integration along the characteristic edges, with three predictor-corrector sweeps. Initial data on $v = 0$ and on $u = -6$: σ is set to its static value on both rays, r follows from the Raychaudhuri constraint, $\phi = B + A\,e^{-u^2}$ on $v = 0$ and $\phi = B(1+v)^{-k}$ on $u = -6$, $B = A/10$, $k = 3/2$ unless stated. Prescribing σ fixes the advanced time v on the initial rays to be the static advanced time of the background, which is also the time in which the Ori tail is written; this matters for the interpretation below. The other natural prescription, fixing $r(v)$ to its static value and letting σ follow from the constraint, forces $\sigma_v \sim e^{\kappa_- v} v^{-5}$ along the tail, so that W underflows; it is a different, badly behaved data set, not a different physics, and is not used.

Validation. For $A = B = 0$ the code reproduces the static interior with error 1.1×10^{-3}, 2.8×10^{-4}, 6.9×10^{-5}, 1.7×10^{-5} at $h = 0.08, \ldots, 0.01$ (measured order 1.998–2.000). With a pulse, the

L_2-norm of the relative Raychaudhuri residual in the u direction is 2.2×10^{-3}, 5.4×10^{-4}, 1.4×10^{-4} for $v \le 20$ and 5.3×10^{-3}, 1.3×10^{-3}, 3.3×10^{-4} for $20 < v \le 60$ at $h = 0.08, 0.04, 0.02$ (order 2.00); in the v direction it is 1.2×10^{-3}, 2.9×10^{-4}, 7.3×10^{-5} for $v \le 20$ (and 3.4×10^{-4}, 8.4×10^{-5}, 2.1×10^{-5} for $20 < v \le 58$). Grids are $u \in [-6, u_1]$, $v \in [0, v_1]$ with $h_u = h_v = h$.

3 Data regular on the event horizon

Purpose. In the data of Section 2 the function σ is prescribed static on the initial rays, so $\sigma_v \to -\kappa_-^{\rm static}$ at the Cauchy horizon by construction. A shift of κ_- from the mass the tail adds to the hole can only show in a time variable that is fixed on the event horizon and is the exterior advanced time. We therefore start the evolution on the event horizon.

Construction. Let $U = e^{\kappa_+ u}$, so that $\mathcal{H}^+ = \{U = 0\}$ and the metric is $ds^2 = -\tilde{W}\,dU\,dv + r^2 d\Omega^2$, regular there. The static solution is a function of $x = Ue^{\kappa_+ v}$: $r = r_+ + z(x)$ with $dr/d\ln x = f(r)/2\kappa_+$ ($f = 1 - 2M_N/r$), $\tilde{W} = -f/(\kappa_+ U)$, $r_U = -\tilde{W}/2$; the interior branch ($x \ge 1$) is integrated in $\ln(r - r_-)$, since $r - r_-$ is exponentially small. On $\mathcal{H}^+$ we impose the Eddington–Finkelstein gauge $r_U = -\tilde{W}/2$, which gives $\tilde{\sigma}_v = -r_v/r + (1 - 2M_N')/(2r)$, and prescribe the tail $\phi(0, v) = B(1 + v)^{-k}$. The radius $r(v)$ on $\mathcal{H}^+$ follows from the Raychaudhuri equation $r_{vv} = \sigma_v r_v - 4\pi r \phi_v^2$ with $r(0) = r_+$ and $r_v(v_{\max}) = 0$: the horizon is teleological and grows by $\Delta r_H \sim 4\pi r \int \phi_v^2 dv/\kappa_+$. Backward integration from $v_{\max}$ is the stable direction; the final radius r_f is fixed by $r(0) = r_+$, and $\mu_f = r_f/2 - M_N(r_f)$ is the mass parameter of the final static hole. Fixing $r_U = -\tilde{W}/2$ fixes v up to a shift, and at late times it is the Eddington–Finkelstein time of the final hole, so $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ is the surface gravity with respect to this v. The ray $v = 0$ carries the static solution with $\phi = B$ and no outgoing flux, and ϕ_v, r_v, σ_v on it are integrated along U. A uniform grid in U fails at late v, because the horizon transition sits at $U \sim e^{-\kappa_+ v}$, a coordinate effect of $U = e^{\kappa_+ u}$ (a run with $h_U = 0.04$ produced NaN at $v \approx 56$ and one with $h_U = 0.02$ at $v \approx 70$; `t_uniform.py`). We use $U = c\,(e^{\kappa_+ \varsigma} - 1)/\kappa_+$, $c = 0.2\,e^{-\kappa_+ v_1}$, uniform in ς, so that the grid is uniform in U near $\mathcal{H}^+$ and logarithmic beyond, with $\sigma_\varsigma = \tilde{\sigma} + \ln g'$, $r_\varsigma = r_U g'$, $\sigma_{\varsigma\varsigma} = \tilde{\sigma}_U g' + \kappa_+$, $\phi_\varsigma = \phi_U g'$. The evolution routine is the unchanged one of Section 2. For $B = 0$ the evolution converges at second order to the exact static solution to $v = 100$ in σ and σ_v (the σ_v error at $U = 1$, $v = 100$ is 2.0×10^{-2}, 5.6×10^{-3}, 1.4×10^{-3} for $h_\varsigma = h_v = 0.2, 0.1, 0.05$); r_U, which is exponentially small in the interior, is not reproduced there to relative accuracy (its logarithm is off by many e-folds), because its size is set by the truncation error (below), and we do not use it. (The same holds for $y = -r_U/\tilde{W}$, which equals $1/2$ on the static solution: on $U = 1$ the single-grid values are -0.8, -3.7×10^3, -1.1×10^7, -8.7×10^{13} at $v = 40$, 50, 60, 80 on the coarsest grid and the three-grid Romberg value is wrong by 7 at $v = 60$. With the tail the physical y is much larger than this noise at $v \approx 60$, which is what Section 5 uses.)

The exponent is dynamical ($k = 3/2$). With the tail on $\mathcal{H}^+$ and nothing else, σ_v on a ray settles to $-\kappa_-(\mu_f)$, where $\kappa_-(\mu)$ is the inner surface gravity of the static hole of mass parameter μ (Table 1; five grids, Romberg-extrapolated). The predicted shifts from the static value 0.795649 are 1.4% ($B = 0.03$) and 4.0% ($B = 0.05$) (2.5% at $B = 0.04$, where only two grids were run: Richardson value 0.77622 against 0.775856). On the ray $U = 0.3$ at $v = 95$ the extrapolated values lie 0.024% and 0.077% above the predictions; the single-grid values at $h = 0.05$ lie 0.15% and 0.21% above, and the sequences converge at second order (ratios of successive differences 3.98, 4.0, 4.0 for each of the three $k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$, $k = 1/2$, $B = 0.03$ and $k = 3/2$, $B = 0.05$ series). The local mass parameter $\mu_{\rm loc} = M - M_N(r)$ measured before inflation sets in agrees with μ_f to 3×10^{-4}–

7×10^{-4} on the ray $U=0.1$ for $40\le v\le 65$ (9.959×10^{-3} against 9.956×10^{-3} at $v=40$, $B=0.03$), and to 0.3–0.9% on the ray $U=0.3$ of the table; this changes κ_- by $\lesssim 10^{-4}$. The shift of κ_- from the accumulated mass is therefore a measured effect, not a gauge identity.

Two qualifications. First, for $k=1/2$ the extrapolated $|\sigma_v|$ lies 0.27% ($B=0.03$) and 0.80% ($B=0.05$) above the prediction on $U=0.3$ (and 0.79% and 2.5% on $U=1$, where the $B=0.05$ value 0.79669 even exceeds the static 0.795649), an order of magnitude more than for $k=3/2$ (0.024% and 0.077% on $U=0.3$, 0.10% and 0.32% on $U=1$). The excess is not a convergence failure (the five-grid sequence converges at second order, Table 1); it is a relaxation effect that is larger for the slower tail, whose later horizon flux still adds mass after the time of the measurement. We have not derived this, but the long runs of Section 4.4 show the excess $|\sigma_v|-\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ falling for both tails, from 1.1×10^{-4} at $v=60$ to 1.1×10^{-5} at $v=290$ ($k=1/2$) and from 3.2×10^{-5} to 5×10^{-8} ($k=3/2$) at $B=0.003$. Second, what is measured is σ_v, not the rate of mass inflation. For every B tried $(0.03, 0.04, 0.05)$ the rays with $U>U_c(B)$ reach $r<0$ ($U_c\approx 3.6$, 3.3, 2.9 from the first NaN column, with $\sigma\to-\infty$ there; the first-NaN v depends on h); we have not established whether this locus is spacelike or that there is a threshold in B in this range. The rays used here, $U\le 1.2$, lie outside the future of that region.

Table 1: $|\sigma_v|$ at $v=95$ for tail-only data on $\mathcal{H}^+$ ($v_1=110$), five grids $h_\varsigma=h_v=0.05,\dots,0.003125$ and their Romberg extrapolation; ray $U=0.3$ (and $U=1$ for the extrapolant). Prediction: $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$; static value 0.795649. Data: `gen_B*_k*_A0_U1_w0.3_v110.json`; script `table_eh.py`, output `results_table_eh.txt`.

k	B	μ_f	$\kappa_-(\mu_f)$	$h=0.05$	0.0125	0.003125	extrap. U=0.3	extrap. U=1
3/2	0.03	9.956×10^{-3}	0.784821	0.78597	0.78507	0.78502	0.78501	0.78561
3/2	0.05	2.7757×10^{-2}	0.763567	0.76518	0.76422	0.76416	0.76416	0.76604
1/2	0.03	5.913×10^{-3}	0.789303	0.79231	0.79147	0.79142	0.79142	0.79557
1/2	0.05	1.6461×10^{-2}	0.777349	0.78443	0.78364	0.78359	0.78358	0.79669

The raw mass function is noise-dominated; its extrapolation is not. With the tail alone, M on the Cauchy-horizon rays is not a physical output of any single grid. For $B=0.03$, $k=3/2$, $U=1$, $v=100$, the five grids $h_\varsigma=h_v=0.05,\dots,0.003125$ give $M=-9.1\times10^{17}$, -2.6×10^{17}, -6.7×10^{16}, -1.5×10^{16}, -1.8×10^{15} and the extrapolation $+2.5\times10^{15}$ (for $k=1/2$: finest 2.4×10^{17}, extrapolated 2.5×10^{17}; at $v=60$ the raw values are -6×10^3 to 3.2×10^4 for $k=1/2$). The single-grid error grows with v: for $k=3/2$, tail only, the finest grid is off by 2%, 18% and 171% of the extrapolated M at $v=60, 80, 100$ (the next grid by 9%, 71%, 683%), and the rate of the single-grid M over $[84, 88]$ is undefined on four of five grids ($M<0$) and 0.632 on the finest against 0.691 for the extrapolant (8.5% low). The errors of the single grids against the extrapolant at $v=100$ ($k=3/2$) are 9.1, 2.7, 0.69, 0.17, 0.044×10^{17} and fall by successive factors 3.4, 3.9, 4.0, 4.0, approaching the factor 4 of an h^2 law. The cause we propose is that the second-order truncation error of the horizon transition acts as a mass perturbation, amplified by the same blueshift as a physical one: for $B=0$ the spurious $\mu=M-M_N(r)$ at $U=0.3$, $v=40$ is $(1.5\text{–}1.7)\times10^{-3}\,(h_\varsigma^2+h_v^2)$ over five combinations of (h_ς, h_v) with $h_\varsigma, h_v\in[0.025, 0.1]$ (`aniso.py`; the two anisotropic pairs $(0.1, 0.025)$ and $(0.025, 0.1)$ give 1.7 and 1.5×10^{-3}); for the tail data Section 5 locates the error of the single-grid M in the factor $\rho=-r_v$ and, at small B, in the absolute error of $y-\frac{1}{2}$. Because the error is a series in even powers of h, Romberg extrapolation over the five grids removes its leading terms: the two highest Romberg levels (all five grids; the four finest) agree to 1.4×10^{-6} in relative terms at $v\ge60$ on all four rays of the five main series (1.1×10^{-4} including

the wide-seed run) (`report_stream.py`), and the extrapolated M is positive and increasing, as (5) requires ($\mu_v > 0$ for $r_u < 0$). What supports calling it converged in the window $v \lesssim 110$ is this internal agreement together with the relation tested below, which the single-grid values do not satisfy; it is not an independent solution and the rate test does not fix the amplitude of M (any solution with the same σ_v and ϕ_v obeys it). Section 5 shows that at larger v, and at the smaller amplitude $B = 0.003$, the level spread of M understates its error by a median factor of 1.4–1.5 $\times 10^2$ ($B = 0.03$) and 4–8 ($B = 0.003$) over $84 \le v \le 290$, with isolated v at which the factor is below 1 (`ray_ratio_all_v.py`), and gives a PDE reference, built from the Raychaudhuri constraints, that is not subject to it.

The relation to be tested follows from the field equations. From r_{uv} and the v-Raychaudhuri equation, with $\mu = M - M_N(r)$,

$$\mu_v = -8\pi r^2 \frac{r_u}{W} \phi_v^2 \equiv g, \tag{5}$$

which we checked on seeded data where M is accurate (ratio of the two sides $1.0016 \to 1.0004$ at $v = 5$, $U = 0.5$, and $0.994 \to 0.9985$ at $v = 30$, $U = 1$, for $h = 0.05 \to 0.025$). If g grows quasi-exponentially at the rate $\lambda = d\ln g/dv$, then $\mu \simeq g/\lambda\,(1 + \lambda'/\lambda^2)$ and $d\ln\mu/dv = \lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$. For $M \gg M_N$ (so that $d\ln\mu = d\ln M$), with r_v/r and $W(1 - 2M_N')/(4rr_u)$ negligible, $\lambda = |\sigma_v| + 2\,d\ln|\phi_v|/dv$, the differential form of the Ori law. This is an asymptotic consequence of the equations, not an identity of the discrete variables (M, σ_v, ϕ_v are evolved independently), and it tests quasi-stationarity and the discretization rather than new physics. It requires $\lambda'/\lambda^2 \ll 1$, so it cannot hold near a node of ϕ_v, where $g \to 0$.

Rate against the relation. We evolve to $v_1 = 110$ on five grids (streaming kernel, `stream.c`, bitwise identical to the stored-array kernel on a test run; $U \le 1.5$; $h_\varsigma = h_v$), take M, σ_v, ϕ_v interpolated linearly in ς to the ray, and extrapolate each. Table 2 compares the rate of the extrapolated M over $\Delta v = 4$ with λ and with $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ (window averages). For the five series (tail-only $k = 1/2, 3/2$; seeded $k = 1/2, 3/2, 5/2$ with $A = 0.02$ at $U_0 = 1$, $w = 0.3$, $B = 0.03$) the difference between the rate and $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ is $\le 2 \times 10^{-4}$ in the windows $[72, 76]$, $[84, 88]$, $[96, 100]$, $[104, 108]$ on the rays $U = 1$ and $U = 1.2$, and on $U = 0.6$ from $[72, 76]$ ($\le 2 \times 10^{-4}$), and, for the seeded runs on $U = 1$, $+0.7$ to $+2.1 \times 10^{-3}$ at $[60, 64]$; we do not know the cause (the seeded ϕ_v has a node at $v \approx 44.5$–47.5, some fifteen units earlier). For the tail alone the agreement is $\le 2 \times 10^{-4}$ also at $[60, 64]$. The relation is valid only once the mass is large: on the rays $U = 0.3$ and 0.6 the difference is 0.01–0.7 while $M \lesssim 10$ (e.g. -1.4×10^{-2} for $M = 9$, $k = 3/2$, tail only, $U = 0.3$, $[84, 88]$) and $\le 4 \times 10^{-4}$ once $M \gtrsim 4 \times 10^2$ (all five series, all four rays, windows from $[72, 76]$). A second tail amplitude, $B = 0.05$ (tail only, five grids, $\kappa_-(\mu_f) = 0.77735$ for $k = 1/2$ and 0.76357 for $k = 3/2$), gives the same: $|\text{rate} - (\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda)| \le 5 \times 10^{-4}$ at $[60, 64]$ and $\le 2 \times 10^{-4}$ from $[72, 76]$, with rates 0.746–0.753 ($k = 1/2$) and 0.672–0.675 ($k = 3/2$); the finest-grid M at $v = 100$ is off by 2% ($k = 1/2$) and 53% ($k = 3/2$), less than at $B = 0.03$ (171% for $k = 3/2$), consistent with a truncation noise that does not grow with B while the physical mass does (the noise was measured only at $B = 0$); at $B = 0.003$ the extrapolation of M itself fails by $v \approx 100$ for $k = 3/2$ (Section 5). The correction λ'/λ matters: without it the difference is up to 1.5×10^{-3} at $[72, 76]$ (seeded $k = 1/2$) and 5.8–7.0 $\times 10^{-3}$ at $[60, 64]$ (seeded $k = 3/2, 5/2$).

Robustness to the seed. Four further seeds were run for $k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$ (A, U_0, w): $(0.01, 1, 0.3)$ on four grids, $(0.02, 0.7, 0.2)$ and $(0.02, 1, 0.5)$ on five, $(0.03, 0.6, 0.3)$ on four. The first agrees to $\le 5 \times 10^{-5}$ for $v \ge 72$ (8×10^{-4} at $[60, 64]$). The second agrees to 5×10^{-4} at $[72, 76]$ and $\le 5 \times 10^{-5}$ after; at $[60, 64]$ it is off by 5.6×10^{-3} (ϕ_v has nodes at $v \approx 34$ and 54). The third fails at late times: ϕ_v changes sign at $v \approx 92$, the rate is 0.52, 0.38, 1.07, 0.82 over $[72, 76]$,

Table 2: Ray $U = 1$, $B = 0.03$, five-grid extrapolation: rate of M over $[v, v+4]$, $\lambda = |\sigma_v| + 2\,d\ln|\phi_v|/dv$, $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ and $|\sigma_v|$ (window averages). For comparison $\kappa_-(\mu_f) = 0.78930, 0.78482, 0.78342$ for $k = 1/2, 3/2, 5/2$. "seed" is $A = 0.02$, $U_0 = 1$, $w = 0.3$.

data	window	rate	λ	$\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$	$\lvert\sigma_v\rvert$
$k = 1/2$, tail only	$[60, 64]$	0.7338	0.7347	0.7340	0.8008
	$[84, 88]$	0.7457	0.7463	0.7457	0.7967
	$[104, 108]$	0.7543	0.7548	0.7544	0.7945
$k = 3/2$, tail only	$[60, 64]$	0.6868	0.6872	0.6869	0.7880
	$[84, 88]$	0.6911	0.6913	0.6911	0.7860
	$[104, 108]$	0.6947	0.6950	0.6947	0.7853
$k = 1/2$, seed	$[60, 64]$	0.7086	0.7077	0.7079	0.7635
	$[84, 88]$	0.7272	0.7285	0.7273	0.7780
	$[104, 108]$	0.7425	0.7433	0.7426	0.7826
$k = 3/2$, seed	$[60, 64]$	0.6948	0.6890	0.6930	0.7704
	$[84, 88]$	0.6861	0.6866	0.6861	0.7803
	$[104, 108]$	0.6926	0.6930	0.6926	0.7831
$k = 5/2$, seed	$[60, 64]$	0.6958	0.6889	0.6938	0.7701
	$[84, 88]$	0.6808	0.6811	0.6808	0.7794
	$[104, 108]$	0.6838	0.6840	0.6838	0.7819

$[84, 88]$, $[96, 100]$, $[104, 108]$ while $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ is 0.52, 0.61, 1.09, 0.82; only the first and last windows are within 2×10^{-3} (the differences are -1.8×10^{-3}, -0.23, -0.018, $+2.0 \times 10^{-3}$): the relation fails over about ± 20 units of v around the node and is off by 1.8×10^{-3} and 2.0×10^{-3} in the end windows. This is the failure that the derivation predicts ($g \to 0$ at the node, λ'/λ^2 not small), not a discretization effect (the extrapolation levels agree). The fourth ($A = 0.03$ at $U_0 = 0.6$) is not in the perturbative regime: on the analysis ray $U = 1$ the solution reaches $r < 0$ between $v = 40$ and 60, and on $U = 0.6$ the extrapolated M is 3.7×10^9 at $v = 60$ and the four grids give both signs at $v = 80$; we do not analyze it. The relation is therefore verified away from nodes of ϕ_v and for perturbative seeds, and is not claimed beyond that.

The ingoing flux on the rays: observations. On these rays $|\phi_v|$ is 7–110 times (tail-only and seeded $k = 1/2, 3/2$; $\sim 3 \times 10^3$ for the seeded $k = 5/2$) the tail transported from $\mathcal{H}^+$ with the high-frequency factor $r_+/r_- \approx 9.36$; against the zero-frequency response $T(0)\,j(v)$ of Eq. (7), which is the proper quasi-static comparison, it is 1.4 ($k = 1/2$) and 9.5 ($k = 3/2$) times larger at $v = 100$ (Section 4.4). The ratios to the transported tail are (tail only, $v = 60, 80, 100$: 9.8, 8.2, 7.1 for $k = 1/2$ and 91, 69, 47 for $k = 3/2$); the flux is nearly independent of the ray ($U = 0.3$–1.2: spread 2.5% for $k = 1/2$, 1% for $k = 3/2$ at $v = 100$). Its local exponent $-d\ln|\phi_v|/d\ln v$ (five-grid extrapolant, window ± 3) is 2.0, 2.2, 2.1 at $v = 60, 80, 100$ for $k = 1/2$ and 3.0, 3.8, 4.6 for $k = 3/2$ (tail only), and 5.5 at $v = 140$ for $k = 3/2$ at $B = 0.003$ (Section 4); the exponents $k + 1 = 1.5$, 2.5 of a transported tail are not reached. The next subsection traces this to a linear response of the interior to the horizon data.

$|\sigma_v|$ and $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ at late times. For the tail alone on $U = 1$, $|\sigma_v|$ decreases towards $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$: for $k = 3/2$ it is 0.7880, 0.7868, 0.7860, 0.7855, 0.7853 at $v \approx 62$, 74, 86, 98, 106 against 0.78482 (0.06% above at the end); for $k = 1/2$ 0.8008, 0.7986, 0.7967, 0.7953, 0.7945 against 0.78930 (0.66%

above, still falling). On $U = 0.3$ the $k = 1/2$ excess stays at 2.0–2.3 $\times 10^{-3}$ over $v = 70$–100 (it falls by about 10% after $v = 80$); this is the origin of the 0.27% in Table 1. The approach does not follow a single power of v (local exponent of the excess on $U = 1$: $0.9 \to 1.7$ for $k = 1/2$ and $2.1 \to 4.4$ for $k = 3/2$ over $v = 60 \to 100$). The seeded runs approach $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ from below (0.7831 at $v = 106$ for $k = 3/2$), presumably because the seed changes the local mass (not measured); they do not test it. At $B = 0.05$ the excess at $v \approx 106$ is 0.20% for $k = 3/2$ (0.7651 against 0.76357, falling from 0.7735 at $v \approx 62$) and 2.1% for $k = 1/2$ (0.7934 against 0.77735). We therefore claim $\sigma_v \to -\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ at these amplitudes only for $k = 3/2$, to 0.06% ($B = 0.03$) and 0.20% ($B = 0.05$) at $v \approx 106$ and still decreasing, and not for $k = 1/2$; for $B = 0.003$ the long runs of Section 4.4 show the agreement for both tails (1.1×10^{-5} for $k = 1/2$ at $v = 290$).

What this does not test. (a) The tail exponent $2k+2$ in M is reached only through Section 5: the extrapolated mass is available to $v \approx 110$ (to $v = 290$ for $k = 1/2$), the exact ray integration extends it, and beyond $v_b = 250$ it is driven by the kernel flux (a linear-response model matched to the PDE at v_b) and, for $k = 1/2$, by an extrapolated excess of $|\sigma_v|$. (b) The PDE window is $v \le 108$ (differential relation), $v \le 290$ ($k = 1/2$ mass, kernel and metric exponent at $B = 0.003$) or, for the flux at $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$, $v \le 440$ (Section 4.3(e)); $\kappa_+ v \lesssim 14$ ($\lesssim 21$ for the flux to $v = 440$). (c) Two tail amplitudes ($B = 0.03$ for the five main series, $B = 0.05$ tail only; $B = 0.04$ only in the text above) and, for the long runs, $B = 0.003$; one inner profile ($m_N = 5$, $a_N = 10$) for the nonlinear runs; the rays with $U > U_c(B)$ reach $r < 0$ and we do not know whether that locus is spacelike or whether there is a threshold in B. (d) Four seeds, of which two give a clean result and one is non-perturbative. (e) The Richardson–Romberg extrapolation assumes an expansion in h^2; we checked internal convergence, the differential relation, the exact ray integration and, in Section 5, a PDE reference built from the Raychaudhuri constraints; the reference agrees with the ray integration, whereas the extrapolated evolved mass differs from both by 10^{-5} at $v = 84$, growing to 7×10^{-2} at $v = 290$ ($k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$). (f) The closure is additive (the uniqueness statement of Paper E [Ownby, 2026b]).

4 Origin of the exponential: the interior impulse response

The scalar equations contain only ϕ_U and ϕ_v, so a constant added to ϕ is irrelevant and the data of the tail-only runs are the single function $j(v) \equiv \phi'_H(v)$ on $\mathcal{H}^+$ (the ray $v = 0$ has $\phi_U = 0$). We first test whether the flux on the Cauchy-horizon side is a response to the initial data on $v = 0$ or to j; it is a response to j (Section 4.1). We then derive the response kernel from the static interior (Section 4.2), test it against the nonlinear evolution (Section 4.3), use it to say where the power law takes over (Section 4.4) and to test a conjecture near M^* (Section 4.5), compare it with the literature (Section 4.6), and drive the shell model with the filtered flux (Section 4.7).

4.1 The source is the horizon flux, not the initial data

(a) The seed on $v = 0$ is not the source. With $B = 0$ and the seed $A = 0.02$ alone (two positions and widths), $|\phi_v|$ at $v = 100$ is between 4×10^{-7} and 1×10^{-6} on the four rays, against 1.9×10^{-4} for the tail alone; its local decay rate falls from 0.27 to 0.076 over $v = 50$–100 and is not constant (`phidecay.py`).

(b) The shape of j matters. With $\phi_H = B(1 + v/V_0)^{-k}$, $B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$ and $V_0 = 0.3$, 1, 10, $|\phi_v|(v = 100) = 1.6 \times 10^{-4}$, 1.9×10^{-4}, 9.2×10^{-4} and the local rate $-d \ln |\phi_v|/dv$ at $v = 100$ is 0.0486, 0.0459, 0.0295.

(c) A compact pulse of horizon flux. Take $j(v) = -B\,e^{-((v-v_s)/2)^2}/(2\sqrt{\pi})$ (area $-B$) with $v_s = 10$. The flux on the rays peaks at $v \approx 30$–59 depending on the ray ($v \approx 34$ on $U = 1$, twenty-four units after the pulse), and then decays with $-d\ln|\phi_v|/dv = 0.0589, 0.0565, 0.0534, 0.0514, 0.0502, 0.0494, 0.0489$ at $v = 40, \dots, 100$ ($U = 1$; the rates on the four rays agree to 0.2% at $v = 100$), against $\kappa_+ = 0.04897$. (This run has $B = 0.03$ and changes the hole substantially, $\mu_f = 0.088$; the following tests use $B = 0.003$ unless stated.)

4.2 The kernel from the interior wave equation

In ingoing Eddington–Finkelstein coordinates $ds^2 = -f\,dv^2 + 2\,dv\,dr + r^2 d\Omega^2$ the scalar equation for $\phi = e^{-i\omega v}F(r)$ is $(r^2 f F')' - 2i\omega\, r\,(rF)' = 0$. At r_+ the indicial exponents are 0 and $i\omega/\kappa_+$; the solution regular at the event horizon is $F = 1 + a(r_+ - r) + \dots$ with $a = -i\omega/[r_+(\kappa_+ - i\omega)]$, and the recursion for the higher coefficients has denominators $n(\kappa_+ n - i\omega)$, so the regular solution exists except at $\omega = -in\kappa_+$ ($n = 1, 2, \dots$), where the transfer function has poles: this is the origin of the decay $e^{-\kappa_+\tau}$ and of its rate. At r_- the exponents are 0 and $-i\omega/\kappa_-$, $F \to A(\omega) + B(\omega)(r - r_-)^{-i\omega/\kappa_-}$, and along a ray of fixed U the second term is a function of u alone and does not contribute to $\phi_v = \partial_v\phi|_U$, so that the flux on the Cauchy-horizon side is $\phi_v = -i\omega A\, e^{-i\omega v}$ for horizon data $\phi'_H = -i\omega\, e^{-i\omega v}$, i.e. $T(\omega) = A(\omega)$ and

$$\phi_v = K * j, \qquad K(\tau) = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int T(\omega) e^{-i\omega\tau} d\omega. \tag{6}$$

We compute $A(\omega)$ by integrating the ODE in $\varsigma = \ln(U e^{\kappa_+ v})$ (with $dr/d\varsigma = f/2\kappa_+$) from $r_+ - 10^{-8}$ to $r - r_- \lesssim 10^{-8}$ (vectorized RK4 over ω; `transfer.py`, `transfer_vec.py`) and separate A from the u-only term. The pole structure is checked by the residue at $\omega = -i\kappa_+$: $R_1 = 0.6442$ for $m_N = 5$ (central difference 0.64423; contour integrals of radius $0.3\kappa_+$ and $0.5\kappa_+$: 0.64422, 0.64423; `trace_residues.py`) and $K(\tau)e^{\kappa_+\tau} \to 0.65$ at $\tau \approx 100$ (`residues.py`); the residues at $n \geq 2$ are not reliably computed by the same method, and for $m_N = 1.4$ the second pole, $2\kappa_+ = 0.18 > \kappa_- = 0.164$, lies outside the strip $|\mathrm{Im}\,\omega| < \kappa_-$ in which the limit to the Cauchy horizon is defined, so the expansion $K = \sum R_n e^{-n\kappa_+\tau}$ is there an asymptotic description, not a convergent one; the three-term tail used in the convolutions is a fit to the ODE kernel itself, and dropping its higher terms changes the predictions by $\leq 10^{-3}$.

The zero-frequency gain is exact. For $j = j_0 = \text{const}$ the static solution $\phi = j_0(v + g(r))$ obeys $(r^2 f g')' + 2r = 0$; regularity at r_+ gives $r^2 f g' = r_+^2 - r^2$, and on the outgoing ray ($dr/dv = f/2$) $\phi_v = j_0[1 + (f/2)g'] = j_0(1 + r_+^2/r^2)/2$, so that at $r = r_-$

$$T(0) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} K\,d\tau = \tfrac{1}{2}\big(1 + r_+^2/r_-^2\big) \quad (44.30,\ 14.32,\ 5.33,\ 2.81,\ 1.733 \text{ for } m_N = 5,\ 3,\ 2,\ 1.6,\ 1.4), \tag{7}$$

which the numerical $A(\omega \to 0)$ reproduces (44.298 at $\omega = 10^{-3}$, with an $O(\omega^2)$ correction of 0.0066; the derivation needs only $K \in L^1$ and continuity of A at 0, and ϕ_v here is ∂_v at fixed U on the Cauchy-horizon side). The kernel also contains an instantaneous part: $T(\omega) \to r_+/r_- = 9.36$ as $\omega \to \infty$, so $K = (r_+/r_-)\,\delta(\tau) + K_{\mathrm{reg}}(\tau)$ with $K_{\mathrm{reg}}(0^+) \approx 3.2$ (from $\mathrm{Im}\,T \simeq K_{\mathrm{reg}}(0^+)/\omega$ at large ω). The formula uses only the structure of the wave equation and equals the coefficient b_0 that Ori [1998] finds for Reissner–Nordström (Section 4.6). The scattering is linear and the background static, so the kernel does not depend on the closure; the closure enters only through the back-reaction on M.

4.3 Tests against the nonlinear evolution

(a) The impulse response. For $B = 0.003$ ($\mu_f = 8.5 \times 10^{-4}$; the tail-only ϕ_v/B at $B = 0.03$ and 0.003 differ by 4%) we define $K(\tau) = \phi_v(v_s + \tau)/(-B)$ for pulses at $v_s = 3, 10, 30, 60$ (width 2). On $U = 1$, for $\tau \geq 30$ the kernels for $v_s = 30$ and 60 agree to 0.4% (at $\tau = 60$: 3.670 and 3.684×10^{-2}; $v_s = 3$ and 10 give 3.567 and 3.624×10^{-2}). At late τ the kernel does not depend on the ray ($v_s = 10$: 3.624×10^{-2} at $\tau = 60$ and 6.24×10^{-3} at $\tau = 95$ on both $U = 0.3$ and $U = 1$), but at early τ it does: on a ray that is still on the horizon side at injection ($Ue^{\kappa_+ v_s} < 1$) the response is delayed ($v_s = 10$, $K(\tau = 30) = 7.1 \times 10^{-4}$ on $U = 0.3$, 0.19 on $U = 1$). We call K_∞ the kernel for injections with $Ue^{\kappa_+ v_s} \gtrsim 4$ ($v_s \geq 30$ on $U = 1$). It decays at the local rate 0.0638, 0.0571, 0.0537, 0.0517, 0.0506, 0.0500 at $\tau = 30, \ldots, 80$ and 0.0497 at 85, towards κ_+, and the response to a Gaussian pulse of variance 2 has value 4.3 at $\tau = 0$ (the smoothed delta function plus half the step of $K_{\rm reg}$); the smoothed response is non-zero at $\tau < 0$ (1.2 at $\tau = -2$), so its integral must include that part.

(b) The convolution reproduces the tail-only flux. If the response is linear, $\phi_v(v) = \int K(v - v')j(v')\,dv'$. With the kernel computed from the interior ODE alone (no parameter fitted to the flux data; the pole-tail coefficients $a = 1.063$, $b = 0.056$ of the continuation are fitted to the ODE kernel itself on $60 \leq \tau \leq 120$; the Gaussian smoothing (variance 0.5) and the continuation beyond $\tau = 120$ by the three-term pole expansion are numerical choices, not derived: variances 0.25 and 1 and fit windows $[50, 110]$ and $[80, 140]$ change the prediction by at most 1.2×10^{-3} at $v = 60, 100, 290$ (`kernel_sensitivity.py`, `results_kernel_sensitivity.txt`); `kernel_analytic.py`, `results_kernel_analytic.txt`; the agreement quoted below, 4×10^{-4}, holds for the baseline choice, and the worst of the variants agrees to 1.4×10^{-3}), the ratio of this prediction to the measured, Romberg-extrapolated ϕ_v of the tail-only runs ($B = 0.003$, $U = 1$, four grids, $v_1 = 300$) is 1.0000, 1.0002, 1.0003 for $k = 1/2$ and 0.9996, 0.9998, 1.0003 for $k = 3/2$ at $v = 60$, 100, 290, and it is within 4×10^{-4} at every v of Table 3; the local exponents agree to 0.01. The exponential is therefore the memory of early horizon data carried by the kernel, with the decay rate κ_+ of the event horizon, and the power-law part is $\approx T(0)\, j(v)$ once j varies slowly over the memory time $1/\kappa_+$.

(c) The rate is κ_+ of the profile, for every mass. Repeating (a) with $m_N = 3$, 2, 1.6, 1.4 ($a_N = 2m_N$, $\ell = 1$, pulse at $v_s = 40$, $B = 0.003$), the local decay rate of the kernel at $\tau = 80$, 90–100 is 0.0784, 0.0783 against $\kappa_+ = 0.07827$ ($m_N = 3$), 0.1054, 0.1054 against 0.10541 (2), 0.1102 against 0.1101 (1.6) and 0.0895, 0.0900 against 0.0901 (1.4). The kernel of Section 4.2 reproduces each pulse kernel to 0.5% over $-2 \leq \tau \leq 100$ (`results_kernel_mN.txt`), and the integrals are $\int K_\infty = 14.37$, 5.33, 2.81, 1.733 (trapezoid, tail added) against $(1 + r_+^2/r_-^2)/2 = 14.32$, 5.33, 2.81, 1.733. For $m_N = 5$ the pulse kernels at $B = 0.003$ lie 1.0–1.9% (injection at $v_s = 30$, $\tau \geq 5$) and 1.9–2.4% ($v_s = 60$) above the ODE kernel at $5 \leq \tau \leq 80$ (`results_kernel_pulse_mN5_B0003.txt`), while the tail-only runs of (b), which add less mass, agree to 4×10^{-4}; repeating the $v_s = 60$ pulse with $B = 0.0003$ gives a ratio 1.0002 ± 0.0002 at all $-2 \leq \tau \leq 80$ (`results_kernel_B0003.txt`), so the excess is a nonlinear effect of the pulse (final mass parameter 2.1×10^{-3}), and the 0.2–0.4% at the other masses is presumably of the same origin.

(e) The flux to $v = 420$. The kernel-driven extension of Section 5 uses the kernel beyond $v_b = 250$, where the PDE inputs at $B = 0.03$ are replaced (they reach $v = 300$). To test the kernel to a later advanced time we ran the event-horizon-regular data with $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$ (`gen3_B0.003_k1.5_v450.json`) on four grids ($h = 0.05$ to 0.00625) to $v_1 = 450$; at this amplitude the matching factor is $O(\mu_f) \approx 10^{-4}$ and the kernel is needed at its linear order. The Romberg-extrapolated flux on $U \simeq 1$ divided by the kernel of the static hole (`e12_ratio.py`, `results_e12_ratio.txt`) is 0.99964 at $v = 60$, 0.99979 at $v = 100$, and 1.00032, 1.00032, 1.00030,

1.00030, 1.00031, 1.00030 at $v = 150$, 200, 250, 300, 350, 420 (1.00029 at $v = 440$): constant to 2×10^{-5} over $150 \le v \le 420$, i.e. over $\kappa_+ v$ from 7 to 20, while the flux itself falls by a factor 40 ($2.3 \times 10^{-6} \to 5.8 \times 10^{-8}$). The finest-grid flux alone does not show this (the ratio is 0.986 at $v = 150$ and 0.47 at $v = 400$): the second-order error of the evolved ϕ_v grows with v just as that of r_v does (Section 5), and the second Romberg level departs from the first by 5×10^{-4} at $v = 250$ and 6×10^{-3} at $v = 400$. The flat top level is therefore the only datum we can use, and it is a statement about its stability under extrapolation, not an error bar; the departure of the second level shows that the error control of ϕ_v beyond $v \approx 300$ is weaker than the one we have for M. With that caveat the kernel is confirmed to 3×10^{-4} at a flux level where the exponentially decaying memory component is negligible and the power law of the tail dominates, which is the regime the extension relies on. It is one amplitude and one tail ($B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$); at $B = 0.03$ the flux beyond $v = 300$ remains a kernel prediction with the matching factor of (d).

4.4 Where the power law takes over, and the long runs

(d) The nonlinear excess is mostly the accumulated mass. At $B = 0.03$ the extrapolated PDE flux on $U \simeq 1$ is 3.5% above the kernel of the static hole: the ratio is 1.0354 and 1.0351 at $v = 250$ for $k = 3/2$ and 1/2, drifting down to 1.0346 and 1.0349 at $v = 290$, and at $B = 0.003$ it is 1.0003 for both (`e11_ratio.py`, `results_e11_ratio.txt`). The excess scales as $\mu_f \propto B^2$, and the zero-frequency gain of the hole of mass parameter μ_f, $T(0) = (1 + r_+^2/r_-^2)/2$, is larger than the static one by 2.7% at $\mu_f = 9.96 \times 10^{-3}$ ($r_- = 1.04549$, $r_+ = 9.91846$, $T(0) = 45.500$ against 44.304). Repeating the construction of Section 4.2 for the static hole with $f = 1 - 2(\mu_f + M_N(r))/r$ (`transfer_mu.py`, `kernel_mu.py`, `results_kernel_mu.txt`) lowers the ratio at $B = 0.03$ to 1.0067 for $k = 3/2$ (constant to 7×10^{-5} for $150 \le v \le 290$) and to 1.0186 for $k = 1/2$ (from 1.0211 at $v = 100$), and at $B = 0.003$ to 1.0000 and 1.0002. The displacement of the horizons by the accumulated mass therefore accounts for 81% ($k = 3/2$) and 47% ($k = 1/2$) of the excess at $B = 0.03$. For the physical tails the effect is cleaner: with the kernel of the static hole the ratio at $B = 0.03$ drifts (1.0440 $\to$ 1.0386 between $v = 250$ and 290 for $k = 2$, 1.0639 $\to$ 1.0672 for $k = 3$), whereas with the kernel of the final hole it is constant to 1.4×10^{-4} for $150 \le v \le 290$ at 1.0058 ($k = 2$) and 1.0056 ($k = 3$), as for $k = 3/2$ (1.0067). The remainder (0.6–0.7% for $k \ge 3/2$, 1.9% for $k = 1/2$) is of second order in the amplitude, like the displacement of the horizons, but we do not have its coefficient: it is about 0.48–0.67 μ_f for $k \ge 3/2$ and $3\,\mu_f$ for $k = 1/2$. Its amplitude dependence is tested at $v = 100$ with the five-grid runs to $v = 110$ (`e11_scaling.py`, `results_e11_scaling.txt`): for $k = 1/2$ it is 2.12×10^{-2} at $B = 0.03$ ($\mu_f = 5.91 \times 10^{-3}$) and 6.67×10^{-2} at $B = 0.05$ ($\mu_f = 1.65 \times 10^{-2}$), i.e. $3.6\,\mu_f$ and $4.1\,\mu_f$, a ratio 3.15 against 2.78 for B^2 (a B^4 term of $\sim 13\%$ at $B = 0.05$), and at $B = 0.003$ it is 1.6×10^{-4} at $v \ge 250$ ($2.7\,\mu_f$), which is the level (4×10^{-4}) at which the kernel itself is tested; for $k = 3/2$ it is 7.1×10^{-3} at $B = 0.03$ and -5.5×10^{-4} at $B = 0.003$ at $v = 100$ ($+3 \times 10^{-5}$ at $v = 290$), the latter being the linear-order error of the kernel at that v and not separable from the second-order term. ($B = 0.05$, $k = 3/2$: $\mu_f = 0.0278$ moves the inner horizon of the final hole to $r_- = 1.023$, 3% below the static 1.057 ($T(0) = 47.82$); with the kernel of this final hole the remainder at $v = 100$ is 2.37×10^{-2}, i.e. $0.85\,\mu_f$ against $0.72\,\mu_f$ at $B = 0.03$, a ratio 3.3 to the value at $B = 0.03$ against 2.78 for B^2; `results_e11_scaling.txt`.) The remainder is therefore the first nonlinear correction to the linear response beyond the displacement of the horizons, with a coefficient that depends on the tail ($\sim 0.6\,\mu_f$ for $k \ge 3/2$, 3–4 μ_f for $k = 1/2$); its calculation needs second-order perturbation theory of the scalar equation on the dynamical background, which we have not done. A direct test with a compact flux isolates the remainder from the accumulation of $\mu(v)$ (`e11_pulse.py`, `results_e11_pulse.txt`): for a Gaussian horizon-flux pulse of width 2 and area $-B$ at v_s the PDE

response at $\tau = v - v_s = 60$ exceeds the kernel of the final hole by $\varepsilon = 1.2 \times 10^{-4}$ ($B = 3 \times 10^{-4}$) and 1.25×10^{-2} ($B = 3 \times 10^{-3}$) for $v_s = 60$, and by 9.9×10^{-5} and 1.0×10^{-2} for $v_s = 30$ (all scaling as B^2 to within 3%), i.e. $\varepsilon \simeq 5.8$–$6.0\,\mu_f$, and by 2.2×10^{-6} and 2.2×10^{-4} ($0.25\,\mu_f$) for $v_s = 10$, the same at $v_1 = 110$ and 150. Replacing the kernel of the static hole by that of the final hole removes 35% of the deviation for $v_s \geq 30$ ($9.3 \to 6.0\,\mu_f$) and 93% for $v_s = 10$. A compact pulse has no accumulation of $\mu(v)$, so the remainder is intrinsic to the second-order response, and its coefficient depends on the profile and on the injection time (0.25 to $6\,\mu_f$ for pulses, 0.5–$0.7\,\mu_f$ for the tails $k \geq 3/2$, 3–$4\,\mu_f$ for $k = 1/2$): there is no universal matching factor, only the bound $\varepsilon \lesssim 6\,\mu_f$ over all profiles tested. (A pulse at $v_s = 3$, run at $B = 3 \times 10^{-3}$ only, gives -1.4×10^{-2}; without a linearity check at that v_s it is not used.) A constant matching factor is the correct form for a second-order correction that has relaxed, and the factor is constant in v to 10^{-3} or better between $v = 250$ and 290. The matching factor of the extension of Section 5 is thus a constant of the final-hole kernel, not a drifting quantity. The choice of kernel changes the extension little: $\ln M(v = 2500)$ changes by 3×10^{-3}, 0, 0.017, 0.05 for $k = 3/2$, 1/2, 2, 3 at $B = 0.03$ (and by $\leq 2 \times 10^{-3}$ at $B = 0.003$), and q_M by $\leq 10^{-3}$ for $v \geq 1000$ (`results_ray_extend_ext_mu_*.txt`).

Crossover. Convolving the kernel with $j = -kB(1+v)^{-k-1}$ gives the v at which ϕ_v is within 10% of $T(0)j(v)$ (`crossover_analytic.py`, grid step 10): 200, 310, 370, 500 for $k = 1/2$, 3/2, 2, 3 ($\kappa_- v \approx 160$, 250, 290, 400). Before it, $\phi_v/(T(0)j)$ is 1.4, 9.5, 61, 3.9×10^3 at $v = 100$, and the local exponent overshoots (5.55 at $v = 150$ for $k = 3/2$; 14.1 at $v = 300$ for $k = 3$) before settling to $k + 1$ (2.51, 3.01, 4.01 at $v = 3000$ for $k = 3/2$, 2, 3). Hence, in the window $v \lesssim 110$ of Table 2, $d \ln|\phi_v|/dv \simeq -\kappa_+$ for steep tails, and the Ori rate is $|\sigma_v| - 2\kappa_+$, which for $k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$ is $\kappa_-(\mu_f) - 2\kappa_+ = 0.6869$, to be compared with the measured 0.6868 at $[60, 64]$ (and 0.6911, 0.6947 at $[84, 88]$, $[104, 108]$, where the power law starts to contribute). The closeness at $[60, 64]$ is partly a cancellation between the excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ ($+3.2 \times 10^{-3}$) and the departure of $d \ln|\phi_v|/dv = -0.0504$ from $-\kappa_+$ (-1.4×10^{-3}, contributing -2.9×10^{-3} to λ); Section 4.7 is the better comparison. The tail exponent $2k + 2$ is thus not the rate in the accessible window, but the calculation says when it should be. The physical tails on $\mathcal{H}^+$ for $\ell = 0$ perturbations are $k = 3$ (compact initial data) or $k = 2$ (initially static data), for ϕ on $\mathcal{H}^+$: in the linearized analysis of Gundlach et al. [1994b] the field on the horizon decays as $v^{-(2\ell+P+1)}$ with $P = 2$ (no initial static field) or $P = 1$ (initially static field), i.e. v^{-3} and v^{-2} for $\ell = 0$; the rate v^{-3} for compactly supported data is proved on $\mathcal{H}^+$ by Dafermos and Rodnianski [2005, Theorem 1.1: $|\phi| + |\partial_v \phi| \lesssim v^{-3+\epsilon}$] and Angelopoulos et al. [2018, Eq. (1.11): $\phi|_{\mathcal{H}^+} \sim -8I_0^{(1)} v^{-3}$], while we cite the v^{-2} case on $\mathcal{H}^+$ only from the linearized analysis; the runs use $k = 1/2, 3/2, 5/2$ to resolve the exponent, and for $k = 2, 3$ the kernel puts the emergence of the power law at $v \approx 370$ and 500.

Long runs. Tail-only runs to $v_1 = 300$ with $B = 0.003$ ($k = 1/2$ and 3/2; four grids $h = 0.05, \ldots, 0.00625$, $h_s = h_v$; $\mu_f = 5.9 \times 10^{-5}$ and 9.9×10^{-5}; Romberg over the four grids applied to the *signed* ϕ_v, the two highest levels agreeing to 2.4×10^{-3} at $v = 290$ for $k = 3/2$; `longrun.py`; kernel columns `kernel_analytic.py`) give Table 3. With $\beta \equiv -d \ln|\phi_v|/d \ln(v+1)$ the local exponent of ϕ_v: for $k = 3/2$ it rises from 3.1 at $v = 60$ to 5.5 at $v = 140$ and then falls to 2.74 at $v = 290$, for $k = 1/2$ it passes through 2.15 at $v = 100$ and falls to 1.57; in both cases it is falling towards $k + 1$ (2.5 and 1.5) and is still 10% and 5% above it. The kernel predicts these exponents to 0.01 and the flux to 4×10^{-4}. The metric exponent follows $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ ever more closely: $|\sigma_v| - \kappa_-(\mu_f)$ falls from 1.1×10^{-4} at $v = 60$ to 1.1×10^{-5} at $v = 290$ ($k = 1/2$) and from 3.2×10^{-5} to 5.1×10^{-8} ($k = 3/2$; the next-lower Romberg level gives 5.2×10^{-8}), against a shift $\kappa_-^{\text{static}} - \kappa_-(\mu_f) = 1.0 \times 10^{-4}$ ($k = 3/2$) and 6.2×10^{-5} ($k = 1/2$) from the static value. Since $\lambda = |\sigma_v| + 2\,d \ln|\phi_v|/dv = |\sigma_v| - 2\beta/(v+1)$ exactly, $\lambda - [\kappa_- - 2(k+1)/(v+1)] = -2(\beta - k - 1)/(v+1) + (|\sigma_v| - \kappa_-)$ is a restatement of the exponent crossing: it falls to -4.5×10^{-4}

($k = 1/2$) and -1.6×10^{-3} ($k = 3/2$) at $v = 290$. The Ori rate of the relation of Table 2 is $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$, and the omitted $-\lambda'/\lambda$ is -6.8×10^{-4}, -3.6×10^{-4}, -5×10^{-5} ($k = 1/2$, $v = 100, 140, 290$) and -3.2×10^{-4}, -6.5×10^{-4}, -8.7×10^{-4}, -1.2×10^{-4} ($k = 3/2$, $v = 100, 140, 180, 290$), 8–11% of the deficit at $v = 290$. At the flux level the effective exponent of M is $2\beta \approx 5.5$ ($k = 3/2$) against $2k + 2 = 5$ at $v = 290$: the exponent $2k + 2$ is approached, not reached. Section 5 turns these flux-level statements into statements about M.

v	k	$-d\ln\lvert\phi_v\rvert/dv$	β (meas.)	β (kernel)	$\lvert\sigma_v\rvert - \kappa_-(\mu_f)$	$\lambda - [\kappa_- - \frac{2(k+1)}{v+1}]$
100	1/2	0.02127	2.15	2.15	5.5×10^{-5}	-1.3×10^{-2}
180	1/2	0.00941	1.70	1.70	2.1×10^{-5}	-2.2×10^{-3}
290	1/2	0.00538	1.57	1.57	1.1×10^{-5}	-4.5×10^{-4}
100	3/2	0.04588	4.63	4.63	5.9×10^{-6}	-4.2×10^{-2}
140	3/2	0.03930	5.54	5.54	1.1×10^{-6}	-4.3×10^{-2}
180	3/2	0.02755	4.99	4.99	2.9×10^{-7}	-2.7×10^{-2}
220	3/2	0.01675	3.70	3.70	1.2×10^{-7}	-1.1×10^{-2}
260	3/2	0.01133	2.96	2.96	7.0×10^{-8}	-3.5×10^{-3}
290	3/2	0.00940	2.74	2.74	5.1×10^{-8}	-1.6×10^{-3}

Table 3: Long tail-only runs on $U = 1$, $B = 0.003$, Romberg-extrapolated over four grids ($\kappa_-(\mu_f) = 0.795587$ for $k = 1/2$, 0.795545 for $k = 3/2$; static 0.795649). β is the local exponent of ϕ_v in $v + 1$ (window ±4); "kernel" is the convolution of Section 4.3(b) with the kernel from the interior ODE (`kernel_analytic.py`); $\lambda = |\sigma_v| + 2\,d\ln|\phi_v|/dv$. Data: `results_longrun_v300.txt`, `results_kernel_analytic.txt`.

4.5 A conjecture near M^*, tested and not borne out

The kernel is a property of the static background, and the profiles of Section 4.3(c) are the fixed-ℓ Hayward metrics. The intermediate-regime rate $\kappa_- - 2\kappa_+$ is negative for $M < 1.435\,\ell$ ($\varepsilon < 0.105$, where $\kappa_\pm \to 0.471\sqrt{\varepsilon}/\ell$ coincide), and one might expect a window without exponential growth near the endpoint of the evaporation of Paper A [Ownby, 2026a]. We tested it at $m_N = 1.4$ ($\kappa_- = 0.164$, $\kappa_+ = 0.0901$, $\kappa_- - 2\kappa_+ = -0.016$), tail-only, $k = 3/2$, $B = 0.003$, four grids to $v_1 = 250$ (`kernel_general.py`). The kernel ($T(0) = 1.733$) predicts the measured flux to 0.7% at $v = 40$, 0.3% at 60, 0.13% at 80, 0.1% at 100 and 4×10^{-4} or better for $v \geq 120$, and the flux-level rate $\lambda = |\sigma_v| + 2\,d\ln|\phi_v|/dv$ is $+0.016$ at $v = 40$, $+0.09$ at $v = 100$ and $+0.143$ at $v = 240$ ($\beta = 3.0$, 3.7, 2.53); the analytic λ is negative only for $v \lesssim 14$, outside the range where the relation applies. The reason is the weight of the pole term: $R_1 e^{-\kappa_+\tau}$ is too small a part of the kernel ($R_1 = 0.0368$ against $T(0) = 1.73$ at $m_N = 1.4$, from the residue; the three-term fit to the kernel itself gives 0.0364, the second pole lying outside the strip; 0.644 against 44.3 at $m_N = 5$) and the memory time $1/\kappa_+ = 11$ is short, so the exponential never dominates the flux for a $k = 3/2$ tail. The window of Section 4.4 is therefore a property of heavy holes with steep tails ($\kappa_-/\kappa_+ \gg 1$), and near M^* the only effect on the onset of growth is the usual power-law correction $-2(k+1)/(v+1)$ to κ_-. (This tests the flux, not M, and the closure is additive.)

4.6 Relation to the literature

The ingredients are known, and we do not claim the kernel as new. Ori [1998] computes, for Reissner–Nordström at late times, the coefficient with which an event-horizon tail v^{-n} reappears at the Cauchy horizon, $b_0 = (r_-^2 + r_+^2)/2r_-^2 = (\kappa_+ + \kappa_-)/2\kappa_+$ for $\ell = 0$ (his Eqs. (17)–(18), which

carry an additional factor $(-1)^\ell$ for general ℓ; he states that the result agrees with that of Gürsel et al. 1979, obtained by Fourier integration in the complex plane, and we rely on his statement of this agreement): this is our $T(0)$, Eq. (7), which our derivation shows depends only on the horizon structure of f, not on its form. Kehle and Shlapentokh-Rothman [2019] develop a finite-energy scattering theory for linear waves on the interior of Reissner–Nordström black holes, in which the reflection and transmission coefficients of the separated radial equations are shown to be uniformly bounded in frequency and angular momentum (abstract-level reading; we use nothing beyond this, and the pole structure of our kernel in Section 4.2 is our own computation). Luk and Oh [2017] prove that, for generic smooth compactly supported data on Reissner–Nordström, the solution has infinite nondegenerate energy at the Cauchy horizon, and that Price's law decay is generically sharp along $\mathcal{H}^+$ (abstract-level reading); Costa and Franzen [2017] prove (Reissner–Nordström–de Sitter, the criterion of their Section 1.1 and Theorem 3.1; we read the introduction and the cross-references to the theorem) boundedness of the energy at the Cauchy horizon for data on $\mathcal{H}^+$ decaying exponentially at rate p if $2\min\{p, \kappa_+\} > \kappa_-$, with κ_+ appearing as a cap on the interior decay rate; Hintz and Vasy [2017] show that linear waves on Reissner–Nordström–de Sitter and Kerr–de Sitter are bounded and continuous up to the Cauchy horizon and decay exponentially along it, using radial point estimates tied to the blue-shift and red-shift effects (abstract-level reading). The Costa–Franzen combination $2\kappa_+$ against κ_- is the one that decides the intermediate Ori rate $\kappa_- - 2\kappa_+$ of Section 4.4; we do not claim an equivalence. We did not find the time-domain kernel $K(\tau)$ with its residue R_1, its use as the input of the Ori model, or a comparison with a nonlinear evolution; absence from the sources we could read is not absence from the literature.

4.7 The Ori shell model with the filtered flux

In the shell model the ingoing mass flux is $dm_-/dv = c\,\phi_v^2$; we set $\phi_v = K{*}j$ (kernel of Section 4.2, $B = 0.03$ scaled linearly from the $B = 0.003$ kernel; the measured ϕ_v at $B = 0.03$ is 1.04 times the linear one with the same exponents to 0.06, `flux_nl.py`) with c fixed by $m_-(0) = 0$, $m_-(\infty) = \mu_f$, and run the closure `hn` ($m_N = 5$, $a_N = 10$) for the rate of M_+ (`shell_kernel.py`). The rate depends on the flux through $\kappa_-(m_-) + 2\,d\ln\phi_v/dv$, not on c or the seed. Against the rate of the Romberg-extrapolated M of the PDE (tail-only, $B = 0.03$, $U = 1$) at $v = 60, 72, 84, 96, 104$ (windows of length 4):

		60	72	84	96	104
$k = 3/2$	PDE	0.6868	0.6892	0.6911	0.6931	0.6947
	shell, filtered flux	0.6832	0.6867	0.6891	0.6914	0.6930
	shell $+\,(\lvert\sigma_v\rvert - \kappa_-(\mu_f))$	0.6864	0.6886	0.6903	0.6921	0.6935
	power law $\kappa_- - (2k+2)/(v+1)$	0.7055	0.7182	0.7273	0.7343	0.7381
$k = 1/2$	PDE	0.7338	0.7400	0.7457	0.7510	0.7543
	shell, filtered flux	0.7213	0.7298	0.7375	0.7444	0.7486
	shell $+\,(\lvert\sigma_v\rvert - \kappa_-(\mu_f))$	0.7328	0.7391	0.7449	0.7504	0.7538
	power law	0.7417	0.7493	0.7548	0.7590	0.7613

The shell model has $|\sigma_v| = \kappa_-(m_-)$ exactly, whereas the PDE has the measured excess $|\sigma_v| - \kappa_-(\mu_f) = 3.2,\ 2.0,\ 1.2,\ 0.7,\ 0.5 \times 10^{-3}$ ($k = 3/2$) and $11.5,\ 9.3,\ 7.4,\ 6.0,\ 5.2 \times 10^{-3}$ ($k = 1/2$); with it added, the shell rate agrees with the PDE to 1.2×10^{-3} or better (at most 0.17%), while the power-law input is off by 1.9–4.3×10^{-2} ($k = 3/2$) and 0.7–0.9×10^{-2} ($k = 1/2$). The comparison is not symmetric (the measured excess is added to the filtered input only; without it the filtered shell is worse than the power law for $k = 1/2$ at $v = 60, 72$, with misfits 1.25 and 1.0×10^{-2} against 0.8 and 0.9×10^{-2}, and better from $v = 84$), the agreement of 1.2×10^{-3} is at the level of the

4% difference between the linear and the nonlinear flux (a change of 0.06 in the local exponent changes $2\beta/(v+1)$ by 1.2×10^{-3} at $v\approx100$), and c has no real freedom since it is tied to μ_f. The shell rate is essentially $\kappa_-(\mu_f)+2\,d\ln\phi_v/dv-\lambda'/\lambda$, which is the relation of Table 2 already tested against the PDE, so this is a consistency check of the model's input flux, not an independent test of the shell closure; Section 5 gives the exact version of that relation. It explains, within the shell model, why the measured inflation rates differ from both the static and the final-hole κ_-: they are $\kappa_-(\mu_f)+2\,d\ln\phi_v/dv$ with the filtered flux. It is a test of the shell model against the PDE for the *rate*, in the additive closure and for one data class ($v\le108$); it does not test the amplitude of M.

5 The mass beyond $v\approx110$: exact integration along the ray

Why a different route. The extrapolated mass of Section 3 is reliable only while the truncation error, which grows like the physical mass, stays below it ($v\lesssim110$ at the finest grid). But M itself need not be evolved by the grid. On a ray $U=$ const the field equations form a closed system of ordinary differential equations in v for the area radius and two combinations of its first derivatives, driven by the two quantities that the grid does determine accurately, σ_v and ϕ_v. With $'=d/dv$ at fixed U, $\rho\equiv-r_v$, $y\equiv-r_U/\tilde W$ and $S(r)\equiv(1-2M_N'(r))/(4r)$, the Raychaudhuri equation and Eq. (1) give

$$r'=-\rho,\qquad \rho'=\sigma_v\rho+4\pi r\phi_v^2,\qquad (\ln y)'=\frac{\rho}{r}-\sigma_v+\frac{S(r)}{y},\qquad M=\frac{r}{2}\,(1+4y\rho). \tag{8}$$

They follow from Eqs. (1)–(3) and the Raychaudhuri equation by elementary algebra (Eqs. (1)–(3) are verified in `check_field_equations.py`), so integrating them tests the discrete solution, not the equations. Two exact consequences follow. First, since $M-r/2=2ry\rho$,

$$\frac{d}{dv}\ln\Big(M-\frac{r}{2}\Big)=\frac{4\pi r\,\phi_v^2}{\rho}+\frac{S(r)}{y}, \tag{9}$$

in which σ_v has cancelled; for $M\gg r$ the last term is negligible and $d\ln M/dv=4\pi r\phi_v^2/\rho$. Second, ρ is the flux $4\pi r\phi_v^2$ filtered exponentially at the rate $|\sigma_v|$, $\rho(v)=\int^v e^{-\int_{v'}^{v}|\sigma_{v''}|}\,4\pi r\phi_{v'}^2\,dv'$, so Eq. (9) is the exact form of the quantity $\lambda-\lambda'/\lambda$ of Section 3, whose quasi-stationary expansion is $|\sigma_v|-2\beta/(v+1)+\dots$. The point $y=1/2$ ($M=r/2$ at $\rho\to0$) is an unstable fixed point of the third equation with growth $e^{\kappa-v}$: the amplitude of M is the amplitude of the departure of y from $1/2$, which the ray equations take as data. The identity $y=\frac12+4\pi\int_0^U r\phi_U^2/\tilde W\,dU'$ (from the U-Raychaudhuri equation on the slice $v=$ const) gives it without calibration; it is used below (Eq. (10)).

Test against the extrapolated PDE ($v\le108$). We take r,ρ,y at v_0 from the five-grid extrapolation and integrate (8) (DOP853, relative tolerance 10^{-12}) with the extrapolated $\sigma_v(v)$ and $\phi_v(v)$ (cubic splines) to $v=120$. The maximum of $|M_{\rm ODE}/M_{\rm PDE}-1|$ over $v_0<v\le108$ for $v_0=48,60,72,84$ (block [A] of `results_ray_mass_B0.03_k*.txt`; Table 4 lists $v_0=60$ at selected v) is 6.1×10^{-5} for the tail $k=3/2$ and 2.1×10^{-6} for $k=1/2$, for every v_0, over growth of M from 1.2 to 6.6×10^{17} and from 5.6 to 1.1×10^{20}. The curves obtained from the four starting points coincide, so the calibration is immaterial as long as y, ρ and r at v_0 are accurate (see the caveats below). The deviation is the difference between the extrapolated PDE mass and the mass of the ODE driven by the same σ_v and ϕ_v, whose two highest Romberg levels agree to 2×10^{-13} and 3×10^{-11} at $v=100$ ($k=3/2$); it is therefore an error of $M_{\rm PDE}$ (or of its ingredients y,ρ), which the level spread of $M_{\rm PDE}$ (10^{-7}) does not show: the spread underestimates the difference by

v	M_{PDE}	Romberg levels	$M_{\mathrm{ODE}}/M_{\mathrm{PDE}}-1$	$\mathrm{rate}_{\mathrm{ODE}}$	q_M
$k=3/2$, $B=0.03$, $v_0=60$					
108	6.58×10^{17}	1.1×10^{-7}	$+1.9\times10^{-5}$	0.69513	9.78
140	3.50×10^{27}	4.1×10^{-7}	$+1.0\times10^{-4}$	0.70565	11.16
180	9.81×10^{39}	2.3×10^{-5}	-2.6×10^{-3}	0.72870	10.16
240	2.47×10^{59}	8.0×10^{-5}	$+2.9\times10^{-2}$	–	–
290	9.8×10^{75}	2.3×10^{-3}	-6.6×10^{-2}	0.76587	5.51
$k=1/2$, $B=0.03$, $v_0=60$					
108	1.06×10^{20}	4.2×10^{-9}	-1.2×10^{-6}	0.75508	3.73
140	3.93×10^{30}	8.5×10^{-9}	$+7\times10^{-8}$	0.76533	3.38
180	9.10×10^{43}	1.3×10^{-8}	$+7.2\times10^{-6}$	0.77250	3.04
240	1.45×10^{64}	1.1×10^{-7}	-1.2×10^{-5}	–	–
290	1.17×10^{81}	4.4×10^{-7}	-6.6×10^{-6}	0.77959	2.83

Table 4: Exact ray integration (8) from $v_0=60$ against the five-grid extrapolated PDE mass on $U=1$. "Romberg levels" is the relative difference between the two highest extrapolation levels of M_{PDE}; $q_M=(\kappa_-(\mu_f)-d\ln M/dv)(v+1)$ from the ODE (central difference over ±2). Data: `results_ray_mass_B0.03_k*.txt`.

a factor of at least 8 at every v of Table 4. At every integer $v=84$–290 the ratio of the difference to the spread has median 154 ($k=3/2$) and 136 ($k=1/2$), fifth percentile 11.7 and 6.1, and minimum 0.23 ($v=272$) and 0.77 ($v=223$), next to sign changes of $M_{\mathrm{ODE}}-M_{\mathrm{PDE}}$, which alternates in sign between integer v (`ray_ratio_all_v.py`, `results_ray_ratio_all_v.txt`); at $B=0.003$ the median is 4.3 ($k=3/2$) and 8.3 ($k=1/2$). The next paragraph shows which of the two masses is converged. The statement made here is that the extrapolated mass of Section 3 is a solution of the ray equations with the extrapolated σ_v and ϕ_v to 6×10^{-5} ($k=3/2$) and 2×10^{-6} ($k=1/2$) across seventeen to nineteen decades, not only a mass whose logarithmic derivative matches a relation. It remains a statement about the discrete solution: the equations are those of the closure of the uniqueness statement of Paper E [Ownby, 2026b], and σ_v,ϕ_v come from the PDE (or the kernel, below).

Beyond $v=110$: which mass is converged. For $k=1/2$ at $B=0.03$ the ODE and the extrapolated PDE mass agree to 1.2×10^{-5} up to $v=290$ ($\ln M=186.7$). For $k=3/2$ they differ by 9×10^{-6} at $v=84$, 2.6×10^{-3} at $v=180$ and 7×10^{-2} at $v=290$, with a spread of the two highest Romberg levels of 3×10^{-8}, 2×10^{-5} and 2×10^{-3}. The difference grows steadily; we cannot assign a threshold in v. To decide which mass is converged we repeat the extrapolation with subsets of the five grids (all five; the four finest; the four coarsest, $h=0.05,\dots,0.00625$; the three finest) and integrate the ray equations with each (`ray_stability.py`, `results_ray_stability.txt`). For $B=0.03$, $k=3/2$, $\ln M_{\mathrm{ODE}}$ changes by at most 2×10^{-8} (four finest), 5×10^{-6} (four coarsest) and 1.2×10^{-6} (three finest) over $84\le v\le290$, whereas the extrapolated PDE mass changes by 10^{-4} at $v=140$ and by 0.07–0.6 at $v=290$ from one subset to another; for $k=1/2$ the ODE changes by at most 1.4×10^{-7} and the PDE mass by up to 10^{-4} ($B=0.03$) and 0.2 ($B=0.003$). We conclude that the ray-integrated mass is converged in the grid to $\lesssim10^{-5}$ in $\ln M$ over the whole range, even on the coarse grids, and that the extrapolated PDE mass is not, with a level spread that understates its error by a factor of at least 8 at the v of Table 4 and by a median factor of 1.5×10^{2} ($k=3/2$) and 1.4×10^{2} ($k=1/2$) over all integer $v=84$–290, with minima 0.23 and 0.77 next to sign changes of the difference (at $B=0.003$ the median factor is 4.3 and 8.3; `ray_ratio_all_v.py`). The ODE uses only σ_v and ϕ_v (levels agreeing to 2×10^{-13} and 1.2×10^{-8}, relative, at the tabulated $v\le290$;

at worst over every integer $60 \le v \le 290$ the levels of σ_v agree to 5.1×10^{-13} for $k = 3/2$ and 1.1×10^{-12} for $k = 1/2$ at $B = 0.03$, those of ϕ_v to 1.2×10^{-8} and 3.1×10^{-10}) and the calibration at v_0; the quantity that carries the blueshift, y (and $-r_v$), is evolved from (8) instead of being read from a grid in which the horizon transition carries a second-order truncation error. The next paragraphs give the independent PDE reference that is needed to decide this and locate the error of the evolved mass; at $B = 0.003$ the difference between the extrapolated evolved mass and the ray integration alternates in sign (`results_ray_mass_B0.003_k*.txt`). The ODE rate coincides with the exact form $4\pi r\phi_v^2/\rho$ to 5×10^{-6} and with $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ to 2×10^{-5} or better ($v \ge 84$, $k = 3/2$; 4×10^{-5} for $k = 1/2$); the last comparison tests the quasi-stationary expansion of Section 3 against the same equations and does not discriminate between the two masses.

Which factor carries the PDE error. The mass is $M = \frac{r}{2}(1 + 4y\rho)$, and each factor can be compared, grid by grid, with a value that does not rest on the evolved first derivatives (next paragraph). On the ray $s = 271.25$ ($U \simeq 1$; `e13_errconst.py`) the single-grid errors are pure h^2 (the ratio of the errors of the two finest grids is 4.00 at every v listed), $\delta\rho/\rho = C_\rho(v)\, h^2$ and $\delta y/y = C_y\, h^2$. For $B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$: $C_\rho = -1.8 \times 10^2$, -2.0×10^3, -9.2×10^4 at $v = 40, 60, 100$ (-87, -4.4×10^2, -4.0×10^3 for $k = 1/2$), growing by a factor $e^{0.09}$ per unit v at $v \approx 100$ ($e^{0.05}$ for $k = 1/2$), while C_y stays at -70 to -77 (-37 to -40). At $h = 0.003125$ the evolved $\rho = -r_v$ is therefore wrong by 0.2%, 1.9% and 90% at $v = 40, 60, 100$, and the mass inherits this, whereas y is wrong by 0.07%. At $B = 0.003$, $C_y = -8.3 \times 10^3$ (B^{-2} times the value at $B = 0.03$, up to 10%) and $C_\rho = -2.1 \times 10^5$ at $v = 60$: the truncation error of y is an absolute error of $y - \frac{1}{2}$, which is of order B^2 at the start, so that its relative size grows as B decreases. The cause proposed in Section 3 (the truncation error of the horizon transition acting as a mass perturbation) is thus, in terms of the factors of M, an error of r_v together with the absolute error of $y - \frac{1}{2}$ at the unstable point $y = \frac{1}{2}$. We have not derived the growth of C_ρ; whatever its origin, no second-order grid resolves ρ at $v = 290$ (at $h = 0.003125$ the relative error is already 90% at $v = 100$).

An independent PDE reference: the constraint-projected mass. The two Raychaudhuri constraints, which the free evolution does not enforce but which the solution satisfies, give the two factors without the evolved r_U and r_v. (i) The u-constraint $r_{uu} - \sigma_u r_u + 4\pi r\phi_u^2 = 0$ gives $\partial_u(r_u/W) = -4\pi r\phi_u^2/W$ along every slice $v = $ const, and $y = -r_u/W$ is invariant under reparametrizations of u (we use s). On $\mathcal{H}^+$, $y = \frac{1}{2}$ (EF gauge), so that

$$y_c(v, s) = \frac{1}{2} + \int_0^s \frac{4\pi\, r\, \phi_{s'}^2}{W}\, ds', \qquad \text{exactly,} \tag{10}$$

with a positive integrand: there is no cancellation, and $y > \frac{1}{2}$ on the whole slice. We accumulate the integral (trapezoid rule) along each row in the streaming evolution (`stream2.c`, `gen3.py`), at ray positions chosen on a grid point of the coarsest grid ($s_q = 246.70, \ldots, 271.25$, $U = 0.3003, \ldots, 0.9993$), so that no interpolation enters, and extrapolate it over the five grids like any other field; the two highest Romberg levels agree to $\le 2 \times 10^{-9}$ for $v \le 200$ and $\le 8.3 \times 10^{-9}$ up to $v = 280$ (relative, all runs). (ii) The v-constraint is the first two equations of (8): they give r and ρ from the extrapolated σ_v and ϕ_v and need only r, ρ at a start v_0 (taken from the extrapolated PDE at $v_0 = 60$, after the infall; starting at $v_0 = 48, \ldots, 84$ changes $\ln M_{\rm cc}$ by $\le 10^{-10}$ at $v = 100, 200, 280$ for $B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$, because the filter forgets the start at the rate κ_-). (iii) $M_{\rm cc} \equiv \frac{r}{2}(1 + 4y_c\rho)$. This uses the PDE for σ_v and ϕ_v on the ray, for the profile integral at each v and for r, ρ at v_0 (all well conditioned), and it does not use the third equation of (8) or any calibration of y. Comparing $M_{\rm cc}$ with the ray ODE (Table 5) therefore tests that equation, the calibration at v_0 and the spline interpolation, by a route that has no unstable direction.

k	B	$\ln M_{\rm cc} - \ln M_{\rm ODE}$ at $v =$ 84	140	200	280	$\max_{84\le v\le 280}$ $\lvert\Delta \ln M\rvert$	spread 4 finest	$\ln \mathcal{K} \ge$ ($v = 280$)
1/2	0.03	-1.3×10^{-9}	-1.0×10^{-9}	$+6.3 \times 10^{-9}$	$+2.2 \times 10^{-9}$	$+1.4 \times 10^{-8}$	$+3.6 \times 10^{-10}$	360
3/2	0.03	$+1.9 \times 10^{-10}$	-3.6×10^{-9}	-9.2×10^{-9}	-3.3×10^{-7}	$+3.3 \times 10^{-7}$	$+1.2 \times 10^{-8}$	337
2	0.03	-5.8×10^{-9}	-9.7×10^{-9}	-1.4×10^{-8}	-1.1×10^{-6}	$+1.1 \times 10^{-6}$	$+1.1 \times 10^{-7}$	327
3	0.03	$+7.7 \times 10^{-10}$	-3.0×10^{-9}	$+1.3 \times 10^{-8}$	-1.4×10^{-6}	$+1.4 \times 10^{-6}$	$+7.8 \times 10^{-7}$	319
1/2	0.003	$+3.7 \times 10^{-8}$	$+3.1 \times 10^{-8}$	$+2.6 \times 10^{-8}$	$+1.6 \times 10^{-8}$	$+3.7 \times 10^{-8}$	$+1.3 \times 10^{-10}$	343
3/2	0.003	-9.8×10^{-8}	-9.9×10^{-8}	-4.5×10^{-7}	-2.3×10^{-6}	$+2.3 \times 10^{-6}$	$+4.5 \times 10^{-9}$	323

Table 5: Constraint-projected PDE mass $M_{\rm cc}$ (Eq. (10) and the v-constraint, five-grid Romberg) against the ray ODE (8) calibrated at $v_0 = 60$, on the ray $U \simeq 1$ ($s = 271.25$) of the runs to $v_1 = 300$ (`gen3.py`, `e13_table.py`, output `results_e13_table.txt`); the first two columns are the tail exponent and amplitude, the rows are in the order of the table. "Spread, 4 finest" is the largest change of $\ln M_{\rm cc}$ ($84 \le v \le 280$) when the extrapolation uses the four finest grids instead of five. The last column is the lower bound $\ln(16M^2/r^6)$ on the Kretschmann scalar at $v = 280$ (curvature section of Paper E [Ownby, 2026b]). $\ln M_{\rm ODE}(v = 280)$ is 179, 167, 162, 158, 170, 161 in the order of the rows, and 24, 63, 107 at $v = 84$, 140, 200 for $(k, B) = (3/2, 0.03)$. On the ray $U = 0.3$ the largest $|\Delta \ln M|$ over the same range is 2.5×10^{-6}, 1.1×10^{-5}, 1.3×10^{-5}, 1.4×10^{-5}, 2.0×10^{-4}, 7.6×10^{-4}, almost all of it the amplification of the calibration error at $v_0 = 60$, where $M(60) \approx 0.5 \approx r/2$. Data: `results_e13_*.txt`.

Result. For the six runs (Figure 1) the projected mass and the ray ODE agree to 3.3×10^{-7} ($B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$), 1.4×10^{-8} ($k = 1/2$), 1.1×10^{-6} ($k = 2$), 1.4×10^{-6} ($k = 3$), 2.3×10^{-6} ($B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$) and 3.7×10^{-8} ($k = 1/2$) in $\ln M$ over $84 \le v \le 280$, i.e. over a growth of M by e^{158} to e^{179} (10^{69}–10^{78}), whereas the extrapolated evolved PDE mass is wrong by 7×10^{-2} at $v = 290$ ($B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$) and negative at $v = 200$ for $B = 0.003$. The projected mass itself is stable under the choice of grids: dropping the coarsest grid changes $\ln M_{\rm cc}$ by at most 1.2×10^{-8}, 3.6×10^{-10}, 1.1×10^{-7}, 7.8×10^{-7}, 4.5×10^{-9} and 1.3×10^{-10} in the six runs (same order); for $k = 3$ it is comparable to the disagreement with the ODE, so there the projected mass is known to about 10^{-6} only. The residual disagreement with the ODE is larger than that and grows slowly with v ($\le 10^{-7}$ for $v \le 160$, 2.3×10^{-6} at $v = 280$ for $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$). It is what an error of the extrapolated metric exponent of $\delta\sigma_v \approx 1.5 \times 10^{-9}$ ($B = 0.03$) or 10^{-8} ($B = 0.003$) would produce in the ODE, $d \ln y/dv = \rho/r - \sigma_v + S/y$, integrated over 220 units, and $M_{\rm cc}$ does not integrate σ_v (it enters through ρ only, which is a filtered quantity); these are larger than the level spread of σ_v (2×10^{-13} at the tabulated v and 5.1×10^{-13} at worst over every integer $60 \le v \le 290$ for $B = 0.03$, $k = 3/2$; 2.5×10^{-12} for $B = 0.003$; Section 5). The agreement of two Romberg levels is not an error bound, so it neither excludes nor demonstrates errors of this size; that the residual is caused by $\delta\sigma_v$ is a hypothesis that we have not tested. We take the projected value as the reference and the disagreement as a bound on the error of $\ln M_{\rm ODE}$ from this source. On the ray $U = 0.3$, where $M(v_0) \approx r/2$ and y is close to the unstable point, the ray ODE calibrated on the evolved y is off by 7.6×10^{-4} in $\ln M$ ($B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$; 1.1×10^{-5} at $B = 0.03$) because the 10^{-9} error of the extrapolated $y(v_0)$ is amplified by $e^{\kappa_- \Delta v}$ before y leaves the neighborhood of $\frac{1}{2}$; the projected mass has no such sensitivity, since it needs no $y(v_0)$.

What the projected mass does not do: it takes the same extrapolated σ_v and ϕ_v (through ρ) as the ODE, so it does not reduce their uncertainty: for $k = 1/2$ at $B = 0.03$ the excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$, extrapolated beyond $v = 250$ in the kernel-driven extension, remains the dominant uncertainty of $\ln M$ there. It is a reference for the PDE solution, not for the equations.

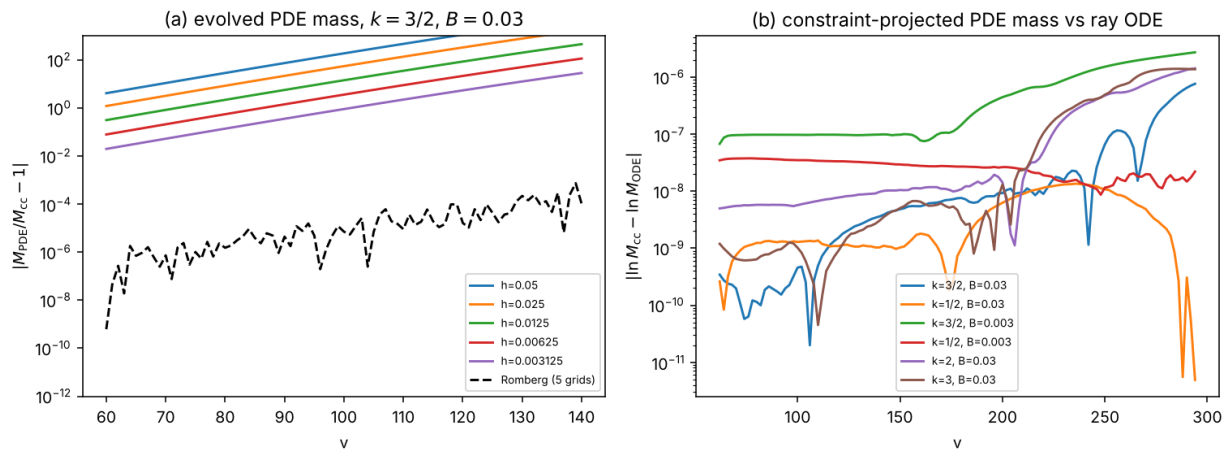


Figure 1: Constraint-projected PDE mass. (a) Relative difference of the evolved PDE mass of each grid and of the five-grid extrapolation from M_{cc} ($k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$, $U \simeq 1$): the single-grid curves scale as h^2 and exceed 100% near $v \approx 100$ (first grid) to beyond $v = 140$. (b) $|\ln M_{cc} - \ln M_{ODE}|$ for the runs of Table 5.

The tail exponent in M. Table 4 and Figure 2 show q_M. For $k = 3/2$ it rises to 11.2 at $v = 140$, falls through 5.99 at $v = 260$ and reaches 5.51 at $v = 290$: the overshoot and the return to $2k + 2 = 5$ are those of the flux exponent (Table 3), now seen in M and not in ϕ_v alone. For $k = 1/2$ it passes through 3.79 at $v = 84$ and reaches 2.83 at $v = 290$, approaching 3 from below because $|\sigma_v|$ has not relaxed to $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ (the excess is 1.1×10^{-3} at $v = 290$, which contributes $-(|\sigma_v| - \kappa_-)(v + 1) = -0.32$).

Kernel-driven extension to $v = 3000$. The PDE inputs are available to $v = 300$. Beyond $v_b = 250$ we use $\phi_v = r_b\,(K * j)$ with the interior kernel of Section 4.2 (no parameter of the kernel is fitted to the PDE flux; its tail coefficients are fitted to the ODE kernel itself and its numerical choices change the prediction by up to 1.2×10^{-3}, Section 4.3(b); $r_b = 1.035$ is a calibration on the PDE, the ratio of PDE flux to kernel flux at v_b for $B = 0.03$, held constant: the nonlinear 3.5% of Section 4.4(d), which changes by $\le 10^{-3}$ between $v = 250$ and 290 and which, with the kernel of the final hole ($r_b = 1.0067$, 1.0188, 1.0058, 1.0055 for $k = 3/2$, 1/2, 2, 3; constant in v), changes the results below by ≤ 0.05 in $\ln M$ at $v = 2500$) and $|\sigma_v| = \kappa_-(\mu_f) + e(v)$, with $e(v)$ the measured excess at v_b (1.4×10^{-3} for $k = 1/2$ and 8.3×10^{-6} for $k = 3/2$) continued as $e(v_b)(v_b/v)^q$, with $q = 1.48$ and 4.42 ($k = 1/2$, 3/2) fitted to the measured excess on $150 \le v \le 250$ and assumed to hold to $v = 3000$ (a model input, not derived); bounds are $e = 0$ and $e = e(v_b)$ held. We integrate (8) in $\ln y$ and $\ln \rho$ (`ray_extend.py`; the kernel helper is `kernel_lib.py`). The PDE-driven and kernel-driven masses can be compared where both exist: at $v = 290$ they differ by 1.5×10^{-3} ($k = 3/2$, $B = 0.03$; $\ln M = 174.908$ against 174.906) and by 2×10^{-4} ($k = 1/2$). Results:

v	$\ln M$ ($k = 3/2$)	q_M ($k = 3/2$)	$\ln M$ ($k = 1/2$)	q_M ($k = 1/2$)
290	174.91	5.51	186.67	2.83
400	259.55	5.175	272.59	2.82
1000	725.77	5.058	743.57	2.86
2000	1507.10	5.028	1530.87	2.89
2500	1898.39	5.022	1924.88	2.90

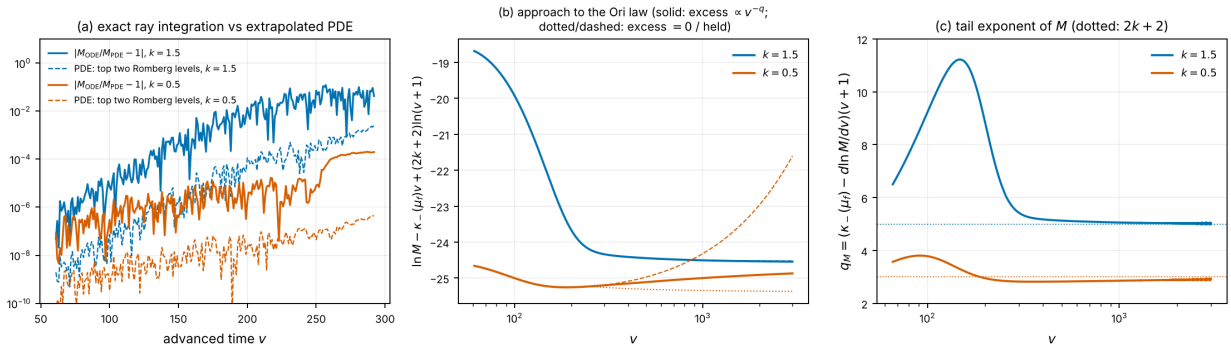


Figure 2: Exact ray integration of M ($B = 0.03$, $U = 1$, $v_0 = 60$). (a) $|M_{\rm ODE}/M_{\rm PDE} - 1|$ (solid) and the spread of the two highest Romberg levels of $M_{\rm PDE}$ (dashed). The solid curve lies above the dashed one by a factor of at least 8 at the v of Table 4; over all integer $v = 84$–290 the median factor is 1.5×10^2 ($k = 3/2$) and 1.4×10^2 ($k = 1/2$) and it falls below 1 at isolated v where the difference changes sign (see text). For $v > 250$ the ODE inputs are kernel-driven, so the $k = 1/2$ curve there measures the error of the kernel inputs ($\approx 2 \times 10^{-4}$ in M at $v = 290$). (b) $\ln M - \kappa_-(\mu_f)v + (2k+2)\ln(v+1)$ to $v = 3000$ with the excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ decaying as a fitted power (solid), set to zero (dotted) or held (dashed) beyond $v = 250$. (c) q_M (dotted: $2k+2$).

For $k = 3/2$, $q_M = 5.02$ at $v = 2500$ against $2k+2 = 5$ and $\ln M - \kappa_-(\mu_f)v + 5\ln(v+1)$ is -24.541 at $v = 2500$ and changes by 5×10^{-3} between 2000 and 2500: the Ori law $M \propto v^{-(2k+2)}e^{\kappa_-(\mu_f)v}$ is reached in M at $v \gtrsim 10^3$, the prefactor being set by the history. The three treatments of the excess differ by at most 0.02 in $\ln M$ ($k = 3/2$, $v = 2500$). For $k = 1/2$ at $B = 0.03$ the corresponding quantity is not converged: q_M is still rising (2.90 at $v = 2500$) and the three treatments of the excess change $\ln M$ by -0.48, $+2.6$ at $v = 2500$ (out of 1925), so the prefactor is uncertain at that level and the approach to 3 is an extrapolation in the excess; the rate itself changes by at most 1.4×10^{-3}. A rate-only version, with r and $|\sigma_v|$ constant and the kernel flux, gives $q_M(v = 3000) = 3.012$, 5.019, 6.023, 8.030 for $k = 1/2$, 3/2, 2, 3 (`ray_rate_only.py`), with the 10% crossover of the flux at $v = 197$, 309, 368, 495 (Section 4.4); this is a statement about the filtering of the kernel flux and is independent of the PDE.

Smaller amplitude, $B = 0.003$. The same runs at $B = 0.003$ ($\mu_f = 5.9 \times 10^{-5}$ and 9.9×10^{-5}) show where the extrapolated mass fails. For $k = 1/2$ the ray integration agrees with $M_{\rm PDE}$ to 4.8×10^{-4} for $v \le 108$ and to 8.5×10^{-4} at $v = 240$. For $k = 3/2$ it differs by 1.0×10^{-2} at $v = 100$ (two highest Romberg levels: 5×10^{-6}), by -0.19 at $v = 180$, and $M_{\rm PDE} < 0$ at $v = 200$. The extrapolated mass is less accurate at the smaller amplitude (differences from the ray integration at $v = 100$: 5×10^{-5} and 10^{-2} for $k = 1/2$, 3/2, against 3×10^{-7} and 7×10^{-6} at $B = 0.03$), as expected if the truncation noise does not shrink with B while the mass does ($M(v = 108)$ is 1.2×10^4 and 5×10^3 times smaller at $B = 0.003$), and its level spread does not warn of it; the scaling $C_y \propto B^{-2}$ found above supports this for y. The ray equations are unaffected: the ODE rate agrees with $4\pi r\phi_v^2/\rho$ and with $\lambda - \lambda'/\lambda$ to 5×10^{-6} ($k = 3/2$, $v = 290$; 2×10^{-5} at $v = 140$), and the excess $|\sigma_v| - \kappa_-(\mu_f)$ is only 1.1×10^{-5} and 5×10^{-8} at $v = 290$, so the extension to $v = 3000$ no longer depends on its treatment. It gives $q_M = 3.145$ at $v = 290$ and 3.012 at $v = 2500$ for $k = 1/2$, and 5.509, 5.022 for $k = 3/2$, i.e. $2k+2$ from above for both tails; $\ln M - \kappa_-(\mu_f)v + (2k+2)\ln(v+1)$ changes by 3×10^{-3} and 6×10^{-3} between $v = 2000$ and 2500, and the three treatments of the excess change $\ln M$ by at most 0.025 out of 1930 (`results_ray_extend_B0.003_k*.txt`).

Physical tails ($k = 2, 3$). The tails expected from Price's law on $\mathcal{H}^+$ (Section 4.4; assumed, not derived here: they are imposed as data on $\mathcal{H}^+$; the rates are those of the references of Section 4.4) were run at $B = 0.03$ to $v_1 = 300$ on the same five grids ($\mu_f = 1.070 \times 10^{-2}$ and 1.154×10^{-2}, $\kappa_-(\mu_f) = 0.783979$ and 0.783028). The constraint-projected mass agrees with the ray integration to 1.1×10^{-6} and 1.4×10^{-6} in $\ln M$ up to $v = 280$ (Table 5), with growth of M by e^{162} and e^{158}. The excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ at $v_b = 250$ is only 9.6×10^{-7} and 3.1×10^{-7}, so the extension does not depend on its treatment (the three treatments differ by at most 2.1×10^{-3} and 6.9×10^{-4} in $\ln M$ at $v = 2500$). The matching factor of the kernel flux at v_b is 1.0440 and 1.0639 for the kernel of the static hole and drifts by 0.5% and 0.3% between $v = 250$ and 290, but is 1.0058 and 1.0055 and constant for the kernel of the final hole (Section 4.4(d)); with the latter the kernel-driven and PDE-driven $\ln M$ agree at $v = 290$ to 10^{-3} for all four runs at $B = 0.03$ (with the static kernel they differ by 1.0×10^{-2}, -5.6×10^{-3}, 1.7×10^{-3} and 5.8×10^{-4} for $k = 2$, 3, 3/2, 1/2, i.e. twice the drift of the factor). The kernel-driven mass gives $q_M = 6.026$ ($k = 2$) and 8.035 ($k = 3$) at $v = 2500$ against $2k+2 = 6$ and 8, from above as for the other tails, and $\ln M - \kappa_-(\mu_f)v + (2k+2)\ln(v+1) = -24.112$ and -23.332 there (changes of 7×10^{-3} and 9×10^{-3} since $v = 2000$). Before the power law is established the rate is lower and q_M is large: at $v = 290$ the rate is 0.7540 ($k = 2$) and 0.6882 ($k = 3$), $q_M = 8.73$ and 27.6, and at $v = 400$ $q_M = 6.27$ and 16.8: the flux of the steep tails is still dominated by the memory component at these v (the kernel puts the crossover at $v \approx 370$ and 500), and the PDE reaches $v = 300$ only. The statement that M reaches the Ori tail law for these tails therefore rests on the kernel-driven extension beyond v_b (to 10^{-3} in $\ln M$ where it can be compared with the PDE, $v \leq 298$), as for the other tails.

Physical tails at $B = 0.003$. The same two tails at $B = 0.003$ ($\mu_f = 1.068 \times 10^{-4}$ and 1.151×10^{-4}, $\kappa_-(\mu_f) = 0.795537$ and 0.795528; `gen3_B0.003_k2_v300.json`, `gen3_B0.003_k3_v300.json`) give, on the ray $U \simeq 1$, a disagreement between the constraint-projected mass and the ray ODE of 2.3×10^{-6} and 5.4×10^{-7} in $\ln M$ at $v = 280$ (growth of M by e^{156} and e^{152}; $\leq 10^{-6}$ for $84 \leq v \leq 200$), and on the ray $U = 0.3$ of 8.7×10^{-4} and 9.6×10^{-4}, the calibration amplification described above (`results_e13_B0.003_k2.txt`, `k3`). The flux is reproduced by the kernel of the final hole to 0.99993 and 0.99947 at $v = 280$, i.e. within the linear-order accuracy of the kernel at this amplitude ($\leq 5 \times 10^{-4}$, Section 4.3), so the matching factor at v_b is 0.99982 and 0.99947 against 1.0058 and 1.0055 at $B = 0.03$: the difference is the B^2 remainder of Section 4.4(d). The excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ at $v_b = 250$ is only 9×10^{-9} and 3×10^{-9}, and the three treatments of it differ by at most 2×10^{-5} and 7×10^{-6} in $\ln M$ at $v = 2500$. The kernel-driven mass gives $q_M = 6.0261$ and 8.0352 at $v = 2500$, equal to the $B = 0.03$ values (6.026, 8.035) to the printed digits, and $\ln M - \kappa_-(\mu_f)v + (2k+2)\ln(v+1) = -33.834$ and -33.104 there (changes of 6.6×10^{-3} and 8.9×10^{-3} since $v = 2000$). The approach of q_M to $2k + 2$ from above, and the value reached at $v = 2500$, are therefore independent of the amplitude for the physical tails, as the rate-only calculation implies.

Caveats. (i) The ray equations are consequences of the field equations: this subsection tests the numerical solution up to $v = 290$ and extends it by the model beyond, and it is not an independent derivation of the amplitude of M. (ii) The ray ODE is calibrated with r, ρ, y at v_0 from the PDE. The constraint-projected mass removes the calibration of y and confirms the ODE (Table 5); the amplitude of M remains that of the discrete solution, through the extrapolated σ_v, ϕ_v, the profile integral and r, ρ at v_0. The evolved y is meaningful only where the physical y exceeds the truncation noise: for the static interior ($B = 0$, $y = 1/2$ exactly) the single-grid y on $U = 1$ is -0.8, -3.7×10^3, -1.1×10^7 at $v = 40, 50, 60$ on the coarsest grid and the three-grid Romberg

value is wrong by 7 at $v = 60$ (`results_static_y_noise.txt`); for the tail data y at $v_0 = 60$ is dominated by the physical mass. The starting points $v_0 = 48, \ldots, 84$ give the same curve, which supports the calibration. At $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$, $M(v_0 = 60) = 0.85$ is marginal. (iii) Beyond $v = 250$ the inputs are the kernel flux (linear response of a static interior, matched at v_b by a constant factor, no back-reaction of the accumulated mass on κ_- beyond the measured excess) and an extrapolated excess of $|\sigma_v|$; for $k = 1/2$ at $B = 0.03$ this matters (above). The approach of q_M to $2k + 2$ is a property of this model: filtering a power-law flux with the rate κ_- gives it for any inputs (the rate-only runs have no PDE input). (iv) The closure is additive, one tail amplitude and one inner profile. (v) M is the Misner–Sharp mass on a ray $U = 1$ at $r \approx 1.06$, not the mass of the shell model; the agreement of the two rates is that of Section 4.7.

6 What the method settles, and what it does not

What it settles. In the additive-closure system, with data regular on the event horizon: (i) the metric exponent follows $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ and not the static value (Section 3); (ii) the Cauchy-horizon flux is the linear response of the static interior to the horizon flux, its kernel and decay rate κ_+ follow from the interior wave equation and it is confirmed by the evolution to 4×10^{-4} ($B = 0.003$; to $v = 420$ for $k = 3/2$ at 3×10^{-4}, constant to 2×10^{-5}), and the part of the excess at $B = 0.03$ that is not the displacement of the horizons is intrinsic second order and has no universal coefficient (Section 4); (iii) along a ray the field equations give the mass without the evolved first derivatives, and this reproduces the extrapolated PDE mass to 6×10^{-5} ($k = 3/2$) and 2×10^{-6} ($k = 1/2$) to $v = 108$, while the constraint-projected PDE mass agrees with it to 2.3×10^{-6} in $\ln M$ to $v = 280$ (Section 5); (iv) with a kernel-driven flux beyond $v = 250$ the tail law $2k + 2$ is reached in M at $v \gtrsim 10^3$, and in the window the PDE reaches the rate is $\kappa_-(\mu_f) - 2\kappa_+$ for steep tails, not the tail law.

Limits.

1. *Closure.* The system is the additive closure. The static sector of the mass-tracking closure of the series is realized in four-dimensional quasi-topological gravity, whose double-null dynamics is the subject of Paper F [Ownby, 2026c]; the ingredients of the pipeline (event-horizon-regular data from the exact static solution and the teleological horizon, linear-kernel comparison of the flux, the metric exponent) are applied to it in Paper F with a constrained evolution that integrates the two Raychaudhuri equations; there the flux through the interior agrees with the kernel of this paper to 8×10^{-4} and differs from the additive closure by terms $\propto B^2$. The exact ray integration and the constraint-projected mass are not carried over to that system, and its evolution does not reach the tail regime.

2. *Range.* The nonlinear runs reach $v = 110$ at $\kappa_- v \approx 87$ (to $v = 300$ for the flux and the metric exponent, to $v = 440$ for the flux at $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$), not $v = \infty$; the mass is reconstructed to $v = 290$ by the ray integration, confirmed to $v = 280$ by the constraint-projected mass, and extended to $v = 3000$ by a model.

3. *Rate of the metric exponent.* For $k = 1/2$ at $B \geq 0.03$ the excess of $|\sigma_v|$ over $\kappa_-(\mu_f)$ is not relaxed within $v \leq 300$ and enters the extension as an extrapolated quantity; for $k = 3/2$ it is $\leq 10^{-5}$.

4. *Flux beyond $v \approx 250$ at $B = 0.03$.* It is the kernel prediction with a constant matching factor of the final-hole kernel; the factor is constant in v to 10^{-3} in $250 \leq v \leq 290$ and the choice

of kernel changes $\ln M(v = 2500)$ by ≤ 0.05, but it is not independently measured there. At $B = 0.003$, $k = 3/2$ the kernel is confirmed by the PDE to $v = 420$ (Section 4.3(e)), with the caveat there that the error control of ϕ_v beyond $v \approx 300$ is weaker than that of M.

5. *Amplitude of M.* The ray equations are consequences of the field equations: this tests the numerical solution, it is not an independent derivation of the amplitude of M, which is that of the discrete solution through σ_v, ϕ_v, the profile integral and r, ρ at v_0.

6. *Parameters.* One inner profile ($m_N = 5$, $a_N = 10$) for the nonlinear runs; two tail amplitudes for the five main series and, for the long runs, $B = 0.003$; four seeds, of which two give a clean result and one is non-perturbative; the Richardson–Romberg extrapolation assumes an expansion in h^2 (checked by the internal convergence, the differential relation, the exact ray integration and the constraint-projected mass).

7. *Fitted, assumed and model-supplied inputs.* (a) Kernel: the tail coefficients a, b are fitted to the ODE kernel on $60 \leq \tau \leq 120$, and the smoothing variance and the pole-expansion continuation are numerical choices (changes $\leq 1.2 \times 10^{-3}$ in the prediction; Section 4.3(b)). (b) Extension beyond $v = 250$: r_b is calibrated on the PDE flux at v_b and held constant (≤ 0.05 in $\ln M(2500)$ between the kernels tried), and the continuation $e(v_b)(v_b/v)^q$ of the excess of $|\sigma_v|$ has a fitted exponent q (≤ 0.02 in $\ln M(2500)$ for $k = 3/2$ between the three treatments, -0.48 to $+2.6$ for $k = 1/2$). (c) The tails $k = 2, 3$ on $\mathcal{H}^+$ are assumed (Price's law on $\mathcal{H}^+$: $k = 3$ proved, $k = 2$ linearized, see Section 4.4) and imposed as data. (d) Everything in the PDE series rests on the h^2 expansion assumed by the Romberg extrapolation.

8. *Second-order remainder.* Its coefficient is not computed: second-order perturbation theory of the scalar equation on the dynamical background is needed.

Code and data availability

All code, data and logs of this paper are in the repository doi:10.5281/zenodo.23455605 (code: MIT licence; text, figures and data: CC-BY-4.0). Requirements: Linux with gcc, Python ≥ 3.10, numpy ≥ 2.0, scipy and matplotlib (`code/requirements.txt`); `sh code/build.sh` builds the three C libraries; the top-level `README.md` gives, for every table and number, the script, the command, the run time and the output file, and `code/eh_init/MANIFEST.md` the command that generated each JSON data set. The event-horizon runs of Section 3 are in `code/eh_init/`: `dnU.py` (exact static solution in (U, v), teleological horizon data, grid map, constraint-consistent seed); `run_tail.py`, `t_static4.py`, `conv1.py`, `mucheck.py`, `nanloc.py`, `muid.py`, `seed5.py`, `diffrate5.py`, `phiexp.py`, `phiexp_extrap.py`, `conv3.py`, `noise.py`, `t_uniform.py`; the five-grid pipeline `stream.c` (two-row streaming copy of the evolution routine), `gen.py` (one run per data set, writes the JSON), `analyze.py` (Romberg extrapolation of the signed series, absolute values taken afterwards; rate against λ), `report_stream.py` (the numbers of Table 2 and the ϕ_v exponents), `aniso.py`, `check_field_equations.py` (Eqs. (1)–(3) and the Kretschmann decomposition); the kernel of Section 4: `transfer.py`, `transfer_vec.py`, `residues.py`, `trace_residues.py`, `kernel_ft2.py`, `kernel_analytic.py`, `kernel_general.py`, `kernel_mN.py`, `crossover_analytic.py`, `shell_kernel.py` (needs `code/ori_model.py`, copied from the Paper E archive, doi:10.5281/zenodo.23455587), `flux_nl.py`, `longrun.py`, `kernel_sensitivity.py`, `kernel_test.py`, `phidecay.py`; the exact mass integration of Section 5: `gen2.py` (stores M and all eight fields per ray and grid), `raylib.py` (Eq. (8)), `ray_validate.py`, `ray_long.py`, `ray_mass.py` (Table 4), `kernel_lib.py`, `ray_extend.py` (kernel-driven extension),

`ray_rate_only.py`, `ray_fig.py`; the PDE reference of the same section: `stream2.c` (streaming evolution that also accumulates the row integral of Eq. (10)), `gen3.py`, `e13_project.py`, `e13_all.py`, `e13_errconst.py`, `e13_table.py` (Table 5), `e13_fig.py`; the matching factor: `transfer_mu.py`, `transfer_vec_mu.py`, `kernel_mu.py`, `kernel_lib_mu.py`, `e11_ratio.py`, `e11_scaling.py`, `e11_pulse.py`, `e11_pulse_all.py`; the generator of Table 1, `table_eh.py`; the flux to $v = 420$: `e12_ratio.py` (`results_e12_ratio.txt`, data `gen3_B0.003_k1.5_v450.json`); the JSON files `gen_*.json`, `gen2_*.json`, `gen3_*.json`; logs in `results_*.txt`; `dn2lib.py` is the Python wrapper of the evolution routine, which is `double_null.c` of `code/nonlinear/` (identical to Paper E's). The numbers of Section 2 come from `code/nonlinear/run_validation.py` and `run_checks.py`. `bash verify.sh` in the archive runs all scripts (quick tier about 7 CPU-minutes, `--full` about 73 CPU-minutes), compares 1021 quoted numbers with computed ones and writes `verification/REPORT.md`; the verification scripts are `sympy_checks.py` (exact symbolic check of Eqs. (1)–(3), the constraints, the ray equations and the static-solution steps of Section 4), `static_hole.py` (horizons, surface gravities and $T(0)$ of the static and final holes), `e13_v0.py` (dependence of the projected mass on its starting point v_0), `regen_compare.py` (regeneration of a data set against the shipped JSON) and `paper_numbers.py`, `paper_numbers_kernel.py`, `paper_numbers_ray.py`, `paper_numbers_hist.py`.

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